



गौरव अभियान

Seva Se Samarpan



The Pride of India,
Visionary Prime Minister
Hon'ble Shri.

Narendra Modi ji

Heartiest congratulations



Eknath Sambhaji Shinde
Deputy Chief Minister, Maharashtra



CM
YK

J ND-ND



KARNATAKA EXAMINATIONS AUTHORITY
 Sampige Road, 18th Cross, Malleshwaram, Bangalore-560 012 Phone: 080-23 460 460 (5 Lines)
 e-mail: keaauthority@ka@nic.in Website: <http://kea.kar.nic.in>

Government of Karnataka

No. ED/KEA/ADMN/PGNEET MD-MS /CR-12/2026

NOTIFICATION

PGET-2026 - Admission to Post Graduate Medical courses for the year 2026-27 in the state of Karnataka & admission to In-Service seats of DNB (Primary and Secondary) and Diploma (NBEMS)

Date: 05-10-2026

1. KEA is inviting applications online for admissions to PG Medical courses from the eligible candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 for the year 2026-27 for the available PG Medical Degree / Diploma courses in Government Medical colleges, Government Quota seats in Private and Minority Medical Colleges and Private seats in Private Medical colleges (KPCF, KRLMPCA, AMPCK and Private Universities) located in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
2. As per Government order No., HFW 882 HSH 2021 Bangalore Dated 10-01-2022, KEA is also inviting application online from the eligible Karnataka in-service candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 and desirous of applying DNB / Diploma Courses in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
3. The candidates who have obtained more than or equal to the prescribed minimum 50th percentile in NEET PG 2026 only are eligible to register and apply online for PG Medical courses for the year 2026-27.
4. Non-Karnataka candidates will not be eligible for reservation. Hence, in the NEET-PG 2026 examination, if they have scored the required minimum 50th percentile or above, fixed for 'GENERAL (UR)' category as per the qualifying criteria, then only they are eligible to register for admissions through KEA or for any other seats in the State of Karnataka. Please note that SC/ST/OBC eligibility criteria are applicable to Karnataka SC/ST/OBC candidates only.
5. Interested and eligible candidates can register, apply online and pay the fees for admission to Karnataka PG Medical Degree and Diploma courses from **11.00 am on 05-10-2026 up to 11.00 am on 15-10-2026**.
6. Afterwards, as per PGNEET-2026 **ANNEXURE-18-19**, candidates have to appear for verification at KEA, Bangalore by booking the slot. (Hosted in the KEA Website)
7. Registration fee, details of document verification, original documents to be submitted for document verification, and other details have been published on the KEA Website. Interested and eligible candidates can register by selecting the specified link on the KEA Website apply online and appear for document verification on the specified dates as per their eligibility.
8. Information Bulletin-2026 detailing admission eligibility criteria and other details are hosted on the KEA Website <https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgtmed2026> for the information of the candidates. Before registering through online for admission to PG Medical courses in the state of Karnataka, applicants are hereby informed to read the Information Bulletin PGNEET-2026 and understand the eligibility conditions, educational qualification, classification of seats (different types of category of seats), procedure for conduct of online seat allotment and eligibility to claim such seats.
9. Mere qualifying in NEET-PG 2026 does not confer any right on the candidate for admission unless the candidate fulfils eligibility conditions / submits the documents / certificates. Further, only the candidates who complete the registration process including document verification are eligible for PG Medical seats in Government / Private Colleges in Karnataka.
10. For more details please visit KEA Website <https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgtmed2026>

NOTE: As per NMC, New Delhi letter dated 24-07-2023; all the rounds of counselling including Stray Vacancy Round will be conducted only by KEA in online mode, all the PG NEET qualified candidates are hereby advised to register online and complete the document verification process in KEA to become eligible for admission to PG Medical Courses in the State of Karnataka.

Sd/-
(H. Prasanna, IAS),
Executive Director,

DIPR/CP/JA/3092/2026-27

TAMILNADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
 Head Office : Poonamallee High Road,
 CMRL Admin Building, Koyambedu, Chennai - 600107
 Ph.No. (044) 26426773 Email ID : tnscsc.tn@nic.in
 CIN:U15137TN1972SGC006157

**SHORT E-TENDER CUM e-REVERSE AUCTION/
 REVERSE BIDDING NOTICE**

Com1/031692/2026 Date:06.10.2026
Short e-Tender cum e-Reverse auction/ Reverse bidding No. :
 Com1/031692/2026-TNCSCT/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites short electronic tender cum Electronic Reverse Auction for "PURCHASE OF 60,000 MTs. of S Grade Type of sugars for the month of October 2026, November 2026 and December 2026 [Season 2025-26 & 2026-2027]".

Complete e-Tender cum e-Reverse Auction/ Reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgp/app>.

The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III.

Last Date and time for Online Submission : 23.10.2026 upto 10.30 AM

DIPR/3038/Tender/2026

Managing Director



TAMIL NADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION

Poonamallee High Road, Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) Admin Building,
Koyambode, Chennai-600 107, Ph.No. (044) 26425773
Email Id : tncsc.in@nic.in | CINC015137TN-99724SGC060157



SHORT E-TENDER CUM REVERSE E-AUCTION / REVERSE BIDDING

RC.No.BS6/023654/2026

Date: 06.10.2026

Short E-Tender cum Reverse E-Auction / Reverse Bidding

Rc. No. BS6/023654/2026- TNCSC/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites online short electronic tender cum electronic reverse auction / reverse bidding for the Purchase of "60,000 Metric Tons of Tur dal (Split-Husked & Fatka) [Indigenous/Tur Dal (Split Husked-Imported)] Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Split – Husked & Laired No.2) / Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Whole-Husked & Laired No.2) for three months of November 2026, December 2026 and January 2027 as per AGMARK specifications"

Complete short e-tender cum reverse e-auction / reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from <https://intenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

The bidders have to participate only on online bidding with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of class-II or class-III. Last Date and Time for Online Submission: **23.10.2026 up to 11.00 A.M.**

DIPR / 3039 / Tender / 2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

CENTRAL RAILWAY
PUNE DIVISION

**Open Tender Notice No.:
 PUNE_ELECT_TRD_2026_09**
dt. 01.10.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical, Traction), Central Railway, Pune-411001 for and on behalf of the President of India invites open Tenders, **ONLINE** from the reputed contractors for the following work:
Name of the work with its Location:
 Provision of 96F OPGW on OHE Mast/ Portal in Pune Division for communication backbone for ABS, Kavach, LTE-4G, IPMPLS, etc.)
Approximate cost of the work: Rs. 69.42,46,023.35 (Rupees Sixty Nine Crores Four Lakh Fifty Three Thousand Two Hundred and Thirty Five Paise only). Bid security to be deposited: Rs. 1,38,84,900/- (Rupees One Crore Thirty Eight Lakh Eighty Four Thousand Nine Hundred only);
Date & time of closing of tender:
 Tender will be closed on 30.10.2026 at 12:00 Hrs. **Website address:** Tender notice, Eligibility Criteria, complete tender documents and corrigendum if any will be available on website www.ireps.gov.in. **System of tendering:** The 'E' tender documents shall be submitted online only by following the guide line on the CRIS web site given above.

DE/37 Sr. DEE (Traction), Pune

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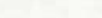


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thehindu**businessline.**








POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION AND RESEARCH CHANDIGARH

Phone No. 0172-2756469

E-Tender Notice No. P/IEP/ 26-27/01

Tender applications are invited for purchase of various items against E-tender No. 1-10 from the Manufacturers or their sole authorized distributors/agents. The bidders can place their bids as per terms & conditions contained on <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.

Sr. No.	Equipment/Item Name	Qty.	EMD (Rs.)	Bid Submission Date	Bid Opening Date	Deptt. Name
Non-Pre Bid case						
1	QLF System	02 Nos.	Rs.1,00,000/-	21-10-2026	22-10-2026	OHSC
2	Dental Air Rotator Lubricating Machine	07 Nos.	Rs.70,000/-	-do-	-do-	OHSC
3	Transport Ventilators	04 Nos.	Rs.80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
4	Complete Shockwave Therapy System	01 No.	Rs.96,000/-	22-10-2026	23-10-2026	Physiotherapy
5	Indirect Colorimeter (Buy Back)	01 No.	Rs.80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
6	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set	01 No.	Rs.80,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology
Pre Bid case						
7	Laser Capture Micro Dissection	01 No.	Rs.4,00,000/-	26-10-2026	27-10-2026	Histopathology
8	Fully Automated Immunoassay : Enzyme Linked Fluorescent Assay (ELFA) Chemoluminescence enzyme Immunoassay(CLEIA)/ Electrochemiluminescence Immunoassay (ECLIA)	01 No.	Rs.3,00,000/-	-do-	-do-	Pediatrics Medicine
9	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set for Emg. OT	01 No.	Rs.1,58,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology
10	Lower Tract Endoscopy Set for TURP, TURBT, OIU, Cystoscopy	01 Set	Rs.1,98,000/-	-do-	-do-	Urology

Tender document can also be downloaded from website www.pgimer.edu.in and can be applied on website www.eprocure.gov.in. Bid Security (EMD) should be for the amount as per the instruments defined in tender documents having its validity at least for one year & duly pledged in favour of **Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh**. The tenders will be opened on the dates given above at 12:00 PM in the presence of the authorized intending tenderers. Tenders not submitted on the prescribed form, not accompanied with Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the tenders received without assigning any reason thereof. **"PRE-BID CONFERENCE" WITH INTENDING BIDDERS FOR ITEM SR. No. 07 to 10 shall be held on 07.10.2026 from 02:30 PM, ONWARDS IN THE P/IEP, OFFICE, PGIMER, CHANDIGARH.** The intending bidders are free to join Pre bid Conference through video conference. For more details contact: 0172-2756469 at Procurement Branch (Import).

NOTE 1. The terms and Conditions of the original Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) available on PGIMER Website will remain same. However on switching over to e-tendering on e-Procurement, the bids will be received in electronic form on e-Procurement website and no bid will be received in Physical form. **The EMD will be received in Physical form in Procurement Branch (Import) and scan copy is to be uploaded in electronic form on e-procurement website, CPPP Portal (Central Public Procurement Portal),**

NOTE 2. If any of the tender opening dates happens to be a holiday in PGIMER, Chandigarh, then the same shall be opened on next full working day.

Additional Terms and Conditions.

- The Institute has adopted amended Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) which is available on e-Procurement website (<https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>) and Website: www.pgimer.edu.in. Therefore the bidders are requested to go through the Instructions Carefully before submitting bids.

PG/IRC/Advt./2026/HR-000530

Professor In-Charge (EP)


Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board
Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli,
Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010.
 Website : <https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in> e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :- JCECEB/48 /26 - 91 Ranchi/Dated: 06 /10/2026

Notice regarding 3rd Round of Online Counselling for MDS All India & NRI Quota Seats of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa on the basis of NEET MDS-2026 Result

Online Application Forms are invited from qualified eligible candidates of NEET MDS-2026 examination for the preparation of all India merit list. Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare Department, Ranchi has earmarked 60% Seats of MDS for All India Quota and 15% for NRI Supported Candidates out of 15 of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa.

2. Interested eligible candidates are requested to fill the **Application Form Online** from **06.10.2026 to 07.10.2026** on Board's official website <http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in> by Clicking on " **Click Here for All Online Application Submission – JCECEB 2026** " tab by following the given directions.

The Candidates already enlisted in All India & NRI Quota merit list of 2nd Round Counselling need not have to apply again. Other terms and conditions and Eligibility criteria are same as per Advt. No.— JCECEB/48/26-86 dated-18.09.2026 which can be seen on Board's website <http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in> in Important Notice Column.

A. Schedule for 3rd Round of Online Counselling for NEET (MDS) - 2026 Course

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule Date
1.	Online Application Form filling & Certificates/Documents Uploading	06.10.2026 to 08.10.2026
2.	Publication of Provisional State Merit List for 3 rd Round of Online Counselling	09.10.2026
3.	Online Registration & Choice Filling for Seat Allotment	10.10.2026 to 12.10.2026
4.	Issue of Provisional Seat Allotment Letter	13.10.2026
5.	Certificates /Documents verification and admission in the concerned Institute	14.10.2026 19.10.2026

3. **Counselling will be held as per the guidelines issued by MCC/DCI New Delhi. In case of any change in guidelines, counselling dates as well as other terms & conditions will be notified accordingly.**

4. **It is mandatory for the candidate to upload Score Card of MDS -2026.**

5. **Applicable Fees:-** Applicants have to pay Application/Registration, Counselling Fee and Security Deposit through Payment Gateway by Credit Card/Debit Card/Net Banking as given below:-

(a) Application/Registration Fee :-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 1000 /-
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of Jharkhand state	₹ 500 /-
3.	Divyang candidate	—

(b) Counselling Fee:-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	₹ 2000 /-
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of Jharkhand state	₹ 1200 /-

© Security Deposit:-

Sl. No.	Institution	Security Deposit
1.	GOVERNMENT	30,000/- (UR/EWS) 15,000/- (ST/SC/OBC/PWD)
2.	Private	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
3.	Both (Government/Private)	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
4.	Stray/Mop-up	50,000/-

6. (a) Security Money will be forfeited if admission is not taken after seat allotment in Second Round and next Round of Counselling. Apart from this, Security Money will not be returned even in case of cancellation of admission in case of giving wrong information by the candidate at the time of registration and not presenting the required original certificates at the time of admission.

(b) The Security Money will be refunded if the candidates have taken valid admission and no seat is allotted after any stage of Counselling.

**By the order of Controller of Examination,
Sd/- Officer on Special Duty**

PR 1301207 (Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board)26-27°D

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)						
The Executive Engineer HPWPD Division Hamirpur Distt. Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the item rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed in the table.						
Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting date for down-loading Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for submission of Bid	Time Limit
1.	Construction of Utility Duct in Hamirpur Town from D.C Office Chowk to Bhota Chowk via main Bazar, and back from Bhota Chowk to D.C. office chowk via existing main bus-stand, and Nadaoun Chowk upto M/S Milkham Rani Petrol Pump Km. 0/0 to 2/885 (SH- C/o main duct from D.C. Office Chowk to Bhota Chowk via main Bazar including Civil Work, infrastructure of HPSEBL & JSV Km. 0/0 to 1/300).	29,70,67,894/-	08-10-2026	39,70,700/-	15-10-2026	Six Months
The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hpntenders.gov.in Executive Engineer, Hamirpur Division, HPWPD Hamirpur, Pin code 177001 Tel. No. 01972-222510, e-mail: ee-ham-hp@nic.in on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh.						
HP / 3924-26-27		HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK				

कार्यालय विद्युत नगर निगम कोटा (राज०)
 क्रमंक:-नपिको / वि० / 2026 / 1573-1580 दिनांक 28.09.2026
:- पत्र :- निविदा सूचना :-
 नगर निगम कोटा द्वारा किसी भी सरकारी या अर्ध सरकारी विभागों में निम्न कार्य को करने वाले अनुभवी संयंत्रों से पुनः ई-निविदा पद्धति से ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। कार्यों की अनुमानित राशियाँ, निविदा भेजे जाने, प्राप्त करने, अन्य शर्तें एवं जानकारी निम्न वेबसाइट <http://kotamc.nigam.co.in> , <http://spppp.rajabsthan.gov.in> & <http://nigam.leprocarajasthan.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती है।
 (अनुमानित राशि 199.46 लाख रुपये)
 NIB code: DLB2627A8121
 UBN is: DLB2627WSOB20942
 राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 11316
 अतिरिक्त अभियंता (वि.)
 नगर निगम कोटा



OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE ENGINEER JAISINGHPUR DIVISION

H.P. PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, JAISINGHPUR -176095

Fax: 01894-228031, e.mail: ee-jaipwd-hp@gov.in

e-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BID(IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Jaisinghpur Division, HPPWD, Jaisinghpur on behalf of the Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on percentage rate of following works from the eligible and approved Contractors/Firms registered with HPPWD Department:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost in Rs.	Earnest Money	Time Limit	Cost of tender form	Start date for down-loading of bid	Deadline for submission of Bid
1.	Balance work for improvement of KJhi Bhuana Ladgalu road KM 0/00 to 6/00 (SH- C/O 8.00 meter span culvert with approached at RD 1/300)	6005626/-	120200/-	Three month	2000/-	10.10.26	15.10.26

The bidders are advised to note other details / Terms & conditions of tenders from the departmental website <https://hptenders.gov.in>. The Executive Engineer reserves the right to reject any tender or all tenders without assigning any reasons.

Executive Engineer
Jaisinghpur Division,
H.P.PWD., Jaisinghpur,
(On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh)

HP / 3928/26-27
HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK.

ENTERPRISE CONNECT

PNB Brings Festive Cheer with 'PNB Utsav Festivities 2026', Offers Special Benefits on Retail Loans

Punjab National Bank has announced the launch of its festive retail loan campaign – 'PNB Utsav Festivities 2026' – Celebrate Dreams, Celebrate Life, offering a range of special benefits on its retail loan product. The campaign is designed to make it easy for customers to turn their festive aspirations into reality, with attractive benefits across Home Loans, Car Loans, Mortgage Loans, Personal Loans and other retail credit products. Commenting on the launch, Subodh Kumar, General Manager PNB, said, "The festive season is a time when aspirations turn into plans and plans into new beginnings. Through PNB Utsav Festivities 2026, we are bringing a comprehensive range of retail lending solutions with attractive benefits to support our customers in fulfilling their dreams of owning a home, purchasing a vehicle, meeting personal financial requirements or unlocking the value of their assets. At PNB, our endeavour is to make access to finance simpler, more convenient and customer-centric." The festive campaign comes at a time when consumer demand typically rises across key categories such as housing, automobiles and personal finance.

Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Limited (HURL) organised 'Apna Samvaad' at its Gorakhpur Plant



Bringing together Lakshpati Drone Didis from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar for an engaging interaction focused on their experiences, achievements and the transformative role of drone technology in agriculture. The programme provided a platform for women entrepreneurs to share their journeys, success stories, experiences and challenges in adopting and using drone technology for agricultural applications. Drone Didis from different locations across Uttar Pradesh and Bihar also joined the programme virtually, sharing the impact of their work in the field and the opportunities that drone-based services are creating for rural livelihoods and entrepreneurship. The interaction was led by Dr. Siba Prasad Mohanty, Managing Director, HURL, who heard the experiences and success stories shared by the Drone Didis and engaged with them on the opportunities and challenges emerging from their work. He encouraged the women entrepreneurs to continue their journey with confidence and emphasised the importance of mutual support, knowledge-sharing and peer learning.

Rajasthan to Make Strong Pitch for Investment, Trade at IITF-2026

Rajasthan is set to make a strong pitch for investment, trade and business opportunities at the 45th India International Trade Fair (IITF)-2026, with the state participating as a Partner State at the prestigious event to be held from November 14 to 27 at Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi. The state will set up a dedicated Rajasthan Pavilion spread over around 1,000 square

metres, showcasing its industrial and business potential, investment opportunities, handicrafts, art, local products and rich cultural heritage before national and international visitors. A meeting to review preparations for Rajasthan's participation in IITF-2026 was held under the chairmanship of Additional Chief Secretary, Industries & Commerce Department, Shri Shikhar Agrawal. Officials from RIICO, Bureau of Investment Promotion (BIP), Khadi, Rajevika, RSLDC, Women & Child Empowerment and other departments and institutions participated in the meeting. Shri Shikhar Agrawal directed the participating departments and institutions to ensure that the pavilion's design and presentation effectively portray Rajasthan's journey from heritage to development, while highlighting the state's achievements, industrial capabilities and investment potential.

**CEO UPSIDA Dr. Balkar Singh
Inspects IMC Prayagraj, Saraswati
Hi-Tech City and Naini Industrial
Area**



Dr. Balkar Singh, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority (UPSIDA), on 2nd Oct'26 conducted a site inspection of the Integrated Manufacturing Cluster (IMC), Prayagraj, Saraswati Hi-Tech City and Naini Industrial Area. During the visit, he reviewed the progress of various development works and directed officials to ensure their completion within the stipulated timelines while maintaining the prescribed quality standards in all construction activities. For Saraswati Hi-Tech City, directions were issued to prepare a comprehensive beautification and development plan. Discussions were also held on developing the available green spaces as recreational areas, along with exploring the feasibility of developing a world-class golf course and a helipad. Officials were further directed to ensure the availability of essential basic amenities to all allottees and maintain proper cleanliness across the area. At the Integrated Manufacturing Cluster (IMC), Prayagraj, discussions were held on developing the existing BPCL structures and plots for commercial use. A plan to develop these plots through the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model for projects such as luxury hotels and marriage gardens was also discussed. During the inspection of the Naini Industrial Area, the concerned officials were directed to take necessary action, as per applicable rules, regarding vacant plots. Directions were also issued to shift the offices of the Regional Manager and Senior Manager to the newly renovated office building located within the Naini Industrial Area.

Amity Group of Schools Announces India's 1st Holistic Future-Readiness Championship – India Mind League 2026

Amity Group of Schools announces the launch of India Mind League (IML) 2026, envisioned as India's 1st Holistic Future-Readiness

Championship for students of Grades IX–XII. Registrations are now open to students from schools across Delhi-NCR, with 16 October 2026 as the last date to register. Envisioned by Dr. (Mrs.) Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools & RBEF, India Mind League reflects her vision of education that goes beyond academic excellence to nurture young people who can think with mindfulness, feel with empathy, connect with purpose and lead with responsibility. The initiative seeks to prepare students not merely for careers, but to become thoughtful, value-driven citizens and future leaders who can contribute meaningfully towards a Viksit Bharat. The championship will unfold through a four-stage journey, beginning with an online Future-Readiness Assessment, followed by a virtual Live Showdown, an experiential Leadership Bootcamp and culminating in a Grand Finale. The initial online assessment will engage students through questions that explore reasoning, pattern recognition, data interpretation, critical thinking and India-centric awareness. Students progressing to subsequent stages will encounter real-life situations, dilemmas and conversations designed to explore emotional intelligence, self-awareness, social sensitivity, judgement, decision-making and leadership.

ICMAI Presents INSCOST Framework for Cost Management and Cost Governance in the Indian Insurance Sector



The Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMA) has presented the "INSCOST – Cost Management, Cost Governance, Cost Disclosure & Cost Assurance Framework for the Indian Insurance Sector", a sector-specific framework developed to strengthen cost discipline, transparency, governance and assurance across the Indian insurance industry. The publication is the First Edition, 2026, brought out by The Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMA), CMA Chittaranjan Chattopadhyay, President, ICMA, stated, "I am pleased to present this Framework at an important stage in the evolution of the Indian insurance sector. As India advances towards the vision of 'Insurance for All by 2047' and the broader objective of Viksit Bharat, sound cost management and cost governance will be increasingly important for efficiency, sustainability and policyholder value." The INSCOST Framework addresses an important structural requirement by providing a dedicated and sector-specific body of guidance covering cost records, cost management, cost governance, cost disclosure and cost assurance, while also extending into strategic cost management and product profitability. During the presentation, ICMA highlighted the framework as the first comprehensive sub-sector differentiated work of its kind globally, covering Life, General, Health, Reinsurance and Public-Sector insurance entities.

JUDICIARY
FOUNDATION COURSE

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English Medium
12 October
11:30 AM

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सुबह 7:30 बजे



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IN BRIEF



Six, including OSD to Mann, booked in 'graft' case

CHANDIGARH
A day after the Punjab and Haryana High Court directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations linked to Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann's office, the probe agency on Tuesday registered an FIR and booked six persons, including Rajbir Ghuman, the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the CM. » Page 4

10 Rajya Sabha seats in U.P. set to face no contest

LUCKNOW
The Samajwadi Party (SP) on Tuesday decided not to field a third candidate for the Rajya Sabha election in Uttar Pradesh, clearing the decks for all 10 seats to be filled without a contest. The ruling BJP has fielded eight candidates and the SP two. » Page 3

Anti-dam stir: call to withdraw forces from Siang belt

GUWAHATI
A tribal youth body in Arunachal Pradesh has asked the government to withdraw the Central Armed Police Forces and State Police personnel deployed to allegedly quell protests against the pre-feasibility report and surveys for a proposed mega hydropower project. » Page 4

OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 2

Rahul calls SIR 'treason' as INDIA unites against ECI; MPs detained

LoP leads sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan after protest march to ECI headquarters stopped; PM Modi 'stole votes to hijack the country', he says; Opposition leaders demand CEC's removal, suspension of SIR, and restoration of deleted names in rolls

Sobhana K. Nair
Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

“What has been done to my country is treason,” Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Tuesday even as the Opposition parties closed ranks, marching from Parliament to the Election Commission of India's (ECI) headquarters to demand the scrapping of special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, restoring the names deleted from the rolls, and sacking of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Later in the evening, Mr. Gandhi, his sister, the Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other MPs were forcibly removed, detained and huddled into a bus even as Mr. Gandhi resisted, attempting to wriggle out of the vehicle's window.

Before being detained, Mr. Gandhi, along with Ms. Vadra and Congress leader K.C. Venugopal, held a sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan, just metres away from Nirvachan Sadan, where the protest march was stopped at 11 a.m. by Delhi Police.

Around 6 p.m., Congress reached out to all parties to join the sit-in. Trinamool's Derek O' Brien and Mahua Moitra, IUM's E.T. Muhammad Basheer, and SP's Mohibullah Nadvi, who were removed earlier in the day by Delhi Police, also returned to join Mr. Gandhi.



Strong pushback: Rahul Gandhi trying to get out of a police van after being detained during a protest in New Delhi on Tuesday. AP

While the Aam Aadmi Party and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam stayed away from the protest, all 19 parties that attended the September 30 Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) meeting were represented.

Joining hands
Top Opposition leaders, including Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, Shiv Sena (UBT)'s Sanjay Raut, and NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule, were seen walking together. For the first time, Biju Janata Dal, which has maintained distance from both the ruling side and

the INDIA bloc, joined in. Communist Party of India MP P. Sandosh Kumar also took part in the protest.

Mr. Yadav accused the ECI of working for the BJP. “Only BJP members can vote. BJP's workers can be India's citizens,” he said, accusing the government of using multiple measures to “steal the mandate”.

He accused the ECI of especially targeting the “Pichde, Dalit and Alpsankhyak (PDA)” (backward, Dalit and minorities). The acronym PDA is a rallying call for his party.

The march began at 10.30 a.m. from Makar Dwar of the Parliament,

with the leaders carrying a banner reading: “Election Commission is compromised - Sack Gyanesh Kumar”. At Akashvani Bhawan, after being stopped by police, the leaders sat down, raising slogans against Mr. Kumar and the government.

Delhi Police had barricaded all roads leading to Parliament amidst heavy security deployment. Around noon, the Delhi Police began bundling the leaders into buses, clearing the site.

CONTINUED ON
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RELATED REPORTS ON
» PAGES 2 AND 11

Could not accept 'unusual demand' for meet outside premises: ECI

NEW DELHI
The Election Commission of India (ECI) said on Tuesday that INDIA bloc parties had demanded a meeting with the full commission at a venue outside its premises, which was “unusual” and therefore “could not be accepted”. The poll body said it had proposed that its senior-most officer on duty could be sent to the meeting venue. It added that this “unprecedented” offer was also declined by the protesting leaders. » PAGE 11

Pioneer of IceCube neutrino detector wins physics Nobel

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

This year's Nobel Prize in Physics will be awarded to Belgium-born Francis Halzen, 82, for his contributions to IceCube, a neutrino observatory in the South Pole, and for the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin.

While there are several massive detectors for these extremely elusive particles, IceCube is designed to find high-energy neutrinos that are believed to have originated far in space from energetic collisions. These “cosmic neutrinos” with extremely high energies are very rare and an enormous volume of ice is needed to observe an adequate number of collisions. Mr. Halzen, who is presently at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, in the U.S., first presented his vision for capturing neutrinos at the South Pole in 1988.

Pure, undisturbed ice is an ideal medium to capture these neutrinos: when they occasionally collide with atomic nuclei, they produce charged particles that announce themselves as a flash of pale blue light.

The South Pole's ice has many advantages, as it is free from various types of interference and the area is geologically stable. Mr. Halzen's idea caught on and, just a few years later, preliminary testing was conducted on sensors in ice. IceCube covers an entire cubic kilometre (or about 917 million litres of water) and was completed in 2010. It has 5,160 optical sensors to detect the Cherenkov light produced by



Francis Halzen

neutrino interactions, with its principal scientific focus on higher-energy astrophysical neutrinos. The Cherenkov light is the blue flash produced when a charged particle travels through a transparent medium faster than light can travel through that medium.

Researchers reported the first high-energy cosmic neutrinos in 2013 and, in 2018, traced one such neutrino to a distant blazar, a galaxy with a supermassive black hole at its centre that fires a jet of particles and radiation almost directly towards earth. “Francis Halzen has led an international team of researchers and engineers who have provided us with a fantastic instrument. His tenacity and scientific vision has paved the way for a new kind of astronomy,” Mark Pearce, Chair of the Nobel Committee for Physics, said.

The neutrino interactions that are continuously collected by IceCube will provide researchers with knowledge about the violent settings in which high-energy neutrinos can be created – and could even reveal previously unknown cosmic phenomena, a statement added.

EDITORIAL
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HIGH TURNOUT IN T.N.
Bypolls held for one LS seat, 5 Assembly seats
NEWS » PAGE 10



TUMULTUOUS CAREER
Bestselling novelist Jeffrey Archer dies
WORLD » PAGE 14



SMRITI TAKES OVER
Harmanpreet quits as India captain
SPORT » PAGE 15

Centre plans 5-pronged reform as GST panel meets tomorrow

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Centre will propose a five-pronged plan for the next set of reforms to the Goods and Services Tax (GST) system at the upcoming GST Council meeting on Thursday, according to sources in the Union Finance Ministry.

These reforms are aimed at automating and easing a lot of the current administrative bottlenecks in the GST system, and reducing the compliance burden, especially for small businesses. Rates, including the GST on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, will not be on the agenda.

The five-pronged proposal covers process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, exports of services, and e-commerce.

Some of the key changes proposed involve automatic invoice matching between buyers and sellers, reducing paperwork

Reform proposal

The five-pronged plan aims at automating and easing administrative bottlenecks in the GST system

FOCUS ON:	
■ Process reforms	■ Key beneficiaries will be small businesses, inter-State businesses, and service exporters
■ Structural reforms	
■ Ease of living and doing business	■ The proposals will be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner
■ Export of services	
■ E-commerce	

around claiming input tax credits (ITC), reducing the number of times small taxpayers have to file returns, and removing multi-state registrations for small businesses looking to sell across the country.

Relief measures

The Centre will be sharing a concept note with the States on allowing small taxpayers who supply only to consumers to file their returns once a year instead of once a month as is currently the case.

Another major demand of service providers is to

widen the net of what constitutes an export.

At the moment, providing a service to a foreign client through a branch abroad is not counted as an export of service. The Centre is proposing to amend this to categorise such business as an export. The proposals are to be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner to give businesses time to adapt to the new systems.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Spy racket involving 13 Navy staffers busted

Rajulapudi Srinivas
VIJAYAWADA

An espionage racket involving 18 people, including 13 personnel working for the Navy, allegedly shared sensitive information with Pakistani operatives, according to intelligence officials from Andhra Pradesh.

Two of the accused, a civilian driver engaged for Navy officers and a Visakhapatnam Naval Base employee, have been arrested.

Officials said on Tuesday that the Counter Intelligence Cell of the Andhra Pradesh uncovered the racket, which allegedly shared information related to defence establishments, including strategic locations at the Visakhapatnam Naval Base, with Pakistani intelligence operatives.

Acting on a tip-off, the counter-intelligence police in Vijayawada registered a case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act,

The A.P. counter intelligence police have arrested a civilian driver and a Visakhapatnam Naval Base employee

the Official Secrets Act, and sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including Section 61(2) (criminal conspiracy).

Under “Operation Firewall-2026”, 12 CIC teams were deployed to Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Goa, Delhi, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Bihar and Chhattisgarh.

The teams, in coordination with Navy officers, anti-terrorist squads, and the local police, conducted searches and examined the complicity of the 18 suspects, and seized electronic equipment from them.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Houthis deny losing ground, claim Riyadh airport attack

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis on Tuesday denied being pushed back by government forces, who have launched a major operation to recapture lost territory. The group also claimed an attack on the Saudi Arabian capital's main airport on Monday night.

The statements came as Yemen's military said it had removed the pro-Iran group from areas around the Bab el-Mandeb strait, a Red Sea chokepoint, and the port city of Mokha. Houthi fighters “have full control over all their advances on the ground”, the militia's spokesperson said. The opposing claims have been impossible to independently verify, with the situation in Yemen developing fast and access for journalists difficult.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

5 Left groups back call for Oct. 10 protest against CEC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Five Left organisations, including the All India Students' Association and the Students' Federation of India, on Tuesday announced support for the October 10 protest "to consolidate the collective movement" against alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Several Opposition leaders as well as the Cockroach Janta Party have called for the protest in the national capital to demand Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

In a collective statement, the Left organisations, which also include the All India Students' Federation, Progressive Students' Union and All India Students' Bloc, wrote: "Delhi and other regions have become hotspots of the ongoing protest joined by thousands every day demanding resignation and prosecution of Gyanesh Kumar, revocation of the draconian SIR and reformation of the Election Commission of India."

The outfits appealed to all "democratic forces and individuals who uphold constitutional values" to join the protest.

Armed with body cameras, Delhi Police swoops down on protesters

Amid allegations of sexual harassment of women by police personnel during ongoing protests near Jantar Mantar, police say camera-fitted devices will help keep record of events at protest sites; security restrictions slow down traffic on key roads

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Delhi Police personnel deployed to manage a protest march by INDIA bloc parties from Parliament to the Election Commission of India (ECI) headquarters on Tuesday were equipped with body cameras amid increased scrutiny of the force's handling of demonstrations and allegations by three women journalists of sexual harassment by officers.

Protests have been held in central Delhi, particularly around Jantar Mantar, over the past few days, with demonstrators demanding the scrapping of the special intensive revision of electoral rolls and the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

On Tuesday, small black devices, resembling walkie-talkies, equipped with a camera lens on the front were clipped to the officers' shirts at chest level, with the lenses pointed towards the protesters and the people around them.

"The cameras will help maintain a video record of events and interactions during the protest



Police personnel detaining protesters during a march by INDIA bloc leaders and MPs at Parliament Street on Tuesday. ANI



A policeman wearing a body camera on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA



and provide footage in case allegations were made against police personnel. This is for collecting evidence," an officer at the site told *The Hindu*.

Security stepped up

Heavy security arrangements were put in place across central Delhi, with multi-layered barricades placed on roads leading to

wards Nirvachan Sadan, the ECI headquarters.

The Delhi police said no permission had been sought for the INDIA bloc protest and reiterated that prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita were in force in the area.

Barricades, diversions and security restrictions slowed traffic on key roads

in Lutyens' Delhi throughout the day as vehicles crawled through diverted routes and faced intermittent stoppages.

Traffic built up on several stretches from India Gate and Connaught Place to Parliament Street and Jantar Mantar as security personnel restricted movement around the protest route. The traffic police

had put special arrangements in place across the New Delhi district from 8 a.m.

The deployment of body-worn cameras comes amid a pending PIL in the Delhi High Court seeking a more comprehensive framework governing their use by police personnel at protest sites and during crowd-control operations.

Court seeks report on 'custodial torture' charges by protesters

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court has granted bail to 17 students and journalists who were taken into police custody on Monday and sought a report from Delhi Police on allegations of "custodial torture" levelled by two protesters.

Judicial Magistrate Animesh Kumar of the Patiala House Courts issued four separate bail orders on Monday night. The arrested persons were protesting outside the Parliament Street police station earlier in the day, demanding registration of an FIR against a police officer accused of molesting a woman journalist during a protest in the national capital against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Delhi Police had registered a case against the 17 accused, alleging that they were part of an unlawful assembly, obstructed a public area, roughed up police personnel and caused damage to public property. Acknowledging the gravity of the allegations, the court pointed out that while any person has the right to protest peacefully, assaulting police officers on duty is a matter of serious concern.

It, however, took into account the age of the ac-



Barricades put up near Akashvani Bhawan on Tuesday. ANI

cused. The judge said the allegations against the accused were "serious" in nature but they were not "habitual offenders". The counsel for the accused had argued that some of the arrested persons had sustained injuries.

CCTV footage

"However, their medico-legal cases were not conducted immediately after the incident," the court noted. It added, "Since the accused Dharmender and Samarth have levelled allegations regarding custodial torture, let a report be called from DCP New Delhi regarding the same. The relevant CCTV footage of the Parliament Street police station be preserved."

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No. PAC/IND/2026-27/170 Date : 06.10.2026

INVITES PROPOSAL
for
O&M Contract for Operation, Maintenance & Management of Tool Room & Technical Service Centre

Pithampur Auto Cluster (PAC) had developed a Tool Room & Technical Service Centre facilities in the year 2009 at 113/2-A, Harniakhedhi, A.B. Road, Opp. Veterinary College, Tehsil-Mhow, Distt. Indore (M.P.) with total initial investment of Rs. 47.40 crores, spread on 5 acres' land. Since inception these facilities are being Operated & Managed by M/s Indo Toolings Pvt. Ltd. (A unit of M/s JMB Auto Ltd., Gurgaon). As the current O&M Contract is going to be expired, PAC is looking for an entity capable to take the responsibility to Operate, Maintain and Manage the Tool Room and Technical Service Centre facilities on "as is where is basis" for the period of 15 years. The complete details of the proposal may be seen at e-portal <https://mptenders.gov.in>. The last date of submission of proposal is 29.10.2026. The document can be purchased online from 08.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.

For any further information/clarification you may contact **CFO, PAC (Mob: 9424011969)**.

M.P. Madhyam/128406/2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

41-year-old man held for throwing acid at woman

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi police have arrested a 41-year-old man for allegedly throwing acid at a 24-year-old woman in Jafrabad on Tuesday.

DCP (North East) Rahool Alwal said the victim was on her way to work when the incident happened, adding that she is under treatment and out of danger. A case has been registered and probe is on.

Rural Development & Panchayat Raj Department
Government of Tamil Nadu

Notification

Rc. No. 1511/2026/A1 Date:06.10.2026

Invitation of Application for the Post of
Director, Social Audit Society of Tamil Nadu (SASTA)

In accordance with the norms, procedures laid down by Government Order No: (Ms) 94 RD&PR (CGS1) Dept. dated 22.08.22. Application for appointment to the post of Director, SASTA is hereby invited. Application format can be downloaded from website <https://crd-training.in/> The application in prescribed format should be submitted on or before 29.10.2026 with all enclosures and DD for Rs.500/- drawn in favour of 'The Director, State Institute of Rural Development and Panchayat Raj'.

Director,
SIRD&PR, TN

DIPR/ 861 /Display/2026

CM and L-G jointly launch healthcare initiatives

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday virtually launched several initiatives, including the headquarters of the State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation at G.B. Pant Hospital, a nursing home management system portal, and the expansion of ANMOL (Advanced Newborn Monitoring and Optimal Life Care) scheme, according to a statement from the Chief Minister's Office.

The monthly incentive for ASHA workers has also been doubled to ₹6,000.

THE HINDU

OPPORTUNITIES

GENERAL

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise and Subsidiary of ONGC Limited) CIN No. : L19200KA1988GOI008959
Kuthethoor Post, Mangalore – 575 030 E-mail: pfte@mrpl.co.in

Date of opening of online portal for submitting application: 09/10/2026
Last Date for submitting online application: 07/11/2026

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited (MRPL), a Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) and a subsidiary of ONGC Limited, invites online applications from bright, energetic and dedicated professionals (Indian Nationals only) for engagement as Personnel on Fixed Term Employment (PFTE).

Advt. No.	Position Name	PFTE Position Level	No. of Posts and Reservation	Mode of Selection*
MRPL/PFTE/2026/03	Fire Officer	Executive Level L1	05 (UR-4, OBC (NCL)-1)	Personal Interview

Abbreviation: UR- Unreserved, OBC (NCL) - Other Backward Caste (Non-Creamy Layer)
* Eligible candidates will be called for Personal Interview (PI) after screening of the applications.
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GENERAL

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Deputy Vice President (Analytical Marketing & Campaign)	1	33	45
Deputy Vice President (Digital Marketing)	2	33	45
Content Specialist	1	25	40

Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/25 (Contractual Position)

Name of Post	Vacancy	Age (As on 31.07.2026)
Head Sales	1	40
Central Research Team (Product Lead)	2	30
Manager (Business Process)	1	30
Project Development Manager (Technology)	1	25
Central Operations Team (COT) Support	1	30

Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/25 (Contractual Position)

For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy details, requisite fees, other details and for online submission of application as well as online payment of application fees log on to Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings>. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees. For any query, please write to us through link "CONTACT US" → "Post Your Query" which is available on Bank's official website (<https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/post-your-query>)

DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES: FROM 30.09.2026 To 21.10.2026.

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Date: 30.09.2026

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PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, MOHAMMAD Husain s/o Ahmad Husain, born on 1-1-1964, residing at H-42 4th Floor Ahmed Apartment Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1 Jamia Nagar New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohd Hussain vide affidavit dated 10-08-2026 at New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under instructions from my clients MADAN LAL (S/o Late Shri Puri Ram) and SARVESH GUPTA (W/o Shri Madan Lal), R/o 737/10, Bhola Nagar, Kirti Nagar, Delhi-110015, it is brought to the notice of the general public that my clients have permanently dissolved, debarred, and severed all relations with their son NITIN GUPTA, his wife PRIYA GUPTA, and minor child SHRIYASH GUPTA, owing to persistent matrimonial disputes, severe misbehavior with mother-in-law Sarvesh Gupta, and disobedience beyond control. My clients hereby disown and disbar them from all their self-acquired movable and immovable properties, bank accounts, and assets. Neither they nor anyone claiming through them shall have any share, right, or title in my clients' properties. Anyone dealing with them in financial, legal, or other transactions shall do so strictly at their own risk and cost. My clients shall not be responsible for any of their debts, liabilities, civil or criminal acts.

ANIL KUMAR GUPTA, Advocate | Delhi High Court (Enrollment No.: D/3364/2012), Chamber 445, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi-110001; Mob: 9911200015

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice by way of publication is hereby given to Grand Peak Infrastructures Pvt. Ltd. in COMPANY PETITION (IB)-16719/2026 titled "J.R. Realcon Private Limited Vs Grand Peak Infrastructures Pvt. Ltd.", that the Petitioner has instituted the above-mentioned petition under Section 7 of the IBC, 2016, which is pending before the Hon'ble NCLT, New Delhi, Principal Bench.

The Hon'ble Bench vide order dated 29.09.2026, directed the Petitioner to effect substituted service upon the Respondent by publication in two local newspapers, one vernacular and one English newspaper having wide circulation in the relevant area.

The Respondent is hereby called upon to appear before the Hon'ble Tribunal and file its response, if any, in accordance with law. The matter is next listed before the Hon'ble Tribunal on 27.10.2026.

In case of non-appearance, the matter may be proceeded with in accordance with law.

By Order of the Hon'ble Tribunal / For the Petitioner

Sd/- SARASA SUBRAHMANYAM, B.A., LL.B., B.S. HARSHA VARDHAN, Advocates,
Society- Colony, Madanapalle Town-517325, Annamaya District, A.P.

DATE: 05.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

Raunak Satpathy Advocate
J.R. Realcon Private Limited

LEGAL NOTICE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
(Order 5 Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure) IN THE COURT OF SH. DEEPAK GARG, LD, PRINCIPAL JUDGE (NORTH) FAMILY COURTS, ROHINI, DELHI

Case No. HMA No. 1274/2025 VEENITA SHARMA VS SAMEER VASHISHTA

To, SAMEER VASHISHTA S/o SH. MANMOHAN VASHISHTA R/o 2, MALKA GANJ, MAIN ROAD, OPP. HANS RAJ COLLEGE, DELHI-110007

WHEREAS it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 16th DAY OF NOVEMBER, 2026 at 10:00 am fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court this 29th Day of September, 2026.

SEAL PRINCIPAL JUDGE (NORTH) FAMILY COURT, ROHINI, NEW DELHI

IN THE COURT OF THE II ADDL DISTRICT JUDGE OF MADANAPALLE (AP)
I.A.No. 161/2026
IN O.S.No: 19/ 2008

PETITIONERS/ PLAINTIFFS: Smt Vijaya Rani and four others
RESPONDENTS/ DEFETS: Smt. Rani Sundarammani (Died) by Lrs and others

NOTICE TO PROPOSED LR/RESPONDENT No-25 in I.A.No.161/2026

Please take notice that consequent on the death of defendant-3 by name Smt Santha Devi w/o Sri Sharath Jawali (Advocate, New-Delhi), I.A.No. 161/2026 is filed to bring on record the Class-I heirs of the deceased defendant-3, in which respondent No- 25 Anupama Jawali, d/o Sharath Jawali (Advocate, New-Delhi) avoided to receive the notices sent by the court. As a result the Honourable Court ordered for steps and publication in the English daily-paper, Accordingly in compliance of the same, notice is hereby taken out to respondent NO-25 by name Anupama Jawali, D/o Sharath Jawali (Advocate, New-Delhi), R/o D.No.C-39, Neethi Bagh, New Delhi South-110049 by way of substitute-service, as per the directions of the Honourable Court. The matter stands posted to 14-10-2026 for the appearance of the above respondent No-25 either in person or through an authorized advocate on 14-10-2026 at 10-30 AM; in default, the matter will be decided ex-parte.

// By order of the court//
Sd/- SARASA SUBRAHMANYAM, B.A., LL.B., B.S. HARSHA VARDHAN, Advocates, Society- Colony, Madanapalle Town-517325, Annamaya District, A.P.

DATE: 06/10/2026

CM YK

M ND-NDE

Not getting work at Dandiya events: Muslim bouncers

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

A collective of bouncers in Hyderabad has raised alarm over discrimination and denial of job opportunities to Muslims for the Dandiya events during the Navratri festival. “Earlier, we used to get contracts for most of the Dandiya events. This year, most of my colleagues have been told that Muslims are no longer welcome to work as bouncers. My team has 10 members, how will I pay them,” asked Mohammed Feroz who is part of the 200-member collective of bouncers.

“Hyderabad was never like this. We have what is called the *Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb* (syncretic culture). This is strange,” he said.

☀️ Timings			
DELHI			
WEDNESDAY, OCT. 07			
☀️ RISE	06:17	🌇 SET	18:01
🌙 RISE	02:47	🌅 SET	16:01
THURSDAY, OCT. 08			
☀️ RISE	06:18	🌇 SET	17:59
🌙 RISE	03:50	🌅 SET	16:33
FRIDAY, OCT. 09			
☀️ RISE	06:18	🌇 SET	17:58
🌙 RISE	04:50	🌅 SET	17:03

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	37	25
Safdarjang	37	25
Palam	34	24

Delhi Palam Today
35°C Mist and haze to occur in pleasant morning. The weather will be dry. Day will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be pleasant.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
34°C The weather will be dry. Day will be warm. Night will be pleasant. Chances of light rain and thundershower at few places.

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SP not to field 3rd candidate; 10 RS seats in U.P. may face no contest

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav wrote on X that party's focus has shifted from 3 to 403, referring to total number of seats in the State Assembly; SP will struggle to cross 50 seats in 2027 poll: Deputy CM; all 8 BJP nominees file papers at the Assembly

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The Samajwadi Party (SP) on Tuesday decided not to field a third candidate for the Rajya Sabha election in Uttar Pradesh, clearing the decks for all 10 seats to be filled without a contest. The BJP has fielded eight candidates and the SP two.

In a social media post, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav indicated that the party's focus has shifted to the 2027 Assembly poll. “Now, our focus is not on three, but on 403,” he wrote on X, referring to the total number of seats in the Assembly.

Term ends on Nov. 25
The terms of 10 Rajya Sabha MPs end on November 25, which has necessitated the elections. Filing of nominations ended at 3 p.m. on Tuesday. All eight



BJP candidates with the CM after filing their nominations for the Rajya Sabha poll at the Vidhan Sabha, in Lucknow on Tuesday. ANI

BJP candidates filed their papers at the Assembly.

Of the eight, three are from OBC groups: Cabinet Minister Dharampal Singh (Lodhi), OBC Morcha State chief Prakash Pal (Pal) and Shruti Gangwar (Kurmi) from Rohilkhand; two are Brahmins: former Allahabad High Court Bar Association president Radha-

kant Ojha and senior party functionary Gopi Krishna Pandey; and two are from Scheduled Castes: Vidya Sagar Sonkar (Khatik) and Priyanka Singh Rawat (Pasi). The eighth nominee, Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan, is a Thakur.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Deputy CMs Keshav Prasad Maurya and Bra-

jesh Pathak, and BJP State president Pankaj Chaudhary were among those present on the occasion.

The two SP candidates, veteran party leader Ram Gopal Yadav and industrialist Dhanraj Parimal Nathwani, have already filed their nominations.

Scrutiny of papers will be held on October 7. Names can be withdrawn till October 9 while polling, if necessary, will be conducted on October 16.

Commenting on the SP chief's post, senior party leader Sudhir Panwar said, “The tweet made it clear that the party is making preparations for all Assembly seats. Our president made it clear that the objective is to form the government in 2027 by defeating the BJP. He also made it clear that the SP is not going to boycott the As-

sembly election on the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) issue but believes people will throw out both the BJP and the CEC in the near future.”

‘Sensible move’
Suheldev Bhartiya Samaj Party chief Om Prakash Rajbhar took a jibe at Mr. Yadav on X. “My friend Akhilesh. It's all done. Sometimes, you still do something sensible. As far as 403 is concerned, I would just say that dreaming is not a bad thing,” he wrote.

Mr. Maurya claimed that the SP will struggle to cross 50 seats in the poll. “Akhilesh is talking about 403, but he used to be exhausted even after winning 100 seats. You have seen his condition in 2022. Will his bicycle (SP election symbol) be able to score a half century this time?” he said.

Form 7 filings linked to BJP, says Owaisi

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Hyderabad MP Asaduddin Owaisi on Tuesday alleged that numerous pre-filled Form 7 applications seeking deletion of voters names from the electoral rolls were submitted in the Goshamah Assembly constituency, a segment which is a part of the Hyderabad Lok Sabha seat, and sought action against the individual who

submitted the forms. Citing a specific example, Mr. Owaisi said 122 Form 7 applications had been submitted at Booth 28 in Goshamah. He said they were part of a deliberate exercise to remove voters belonging to a minority community. Noting that the forms were “pre-printed”, he said his enquiries revealed that one Janardhan, a “BJP supporter or sympathiser”, submitted the forms.

3.7 lakh of 6.66 lakh SIR notices pending in Bengaluru: official

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With hearings on notices issued under the special intensive revision (SIR) scheduled to conclude by October 12, more than 3.70 lakh of the 6.66 lakh notices pending Statewide for hearing are in Bengaluru, Shilpa Nag C.T., Special Commissioner (Election), said while addressing the media on Tuesday.

Of the more than 24 lakh notices issued in Bengaluru over logical discrepancies and no mapping, only 13,550 notices are yet to be delivered.

Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will visit houses and collect the required documents, while hearings will be conducted online only in some cases.

Ms. Nag said 1,117 Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs) have been

appointed to conduct hearings, in addition to the 76 regular AEROs.

Meanwhile, as of Tuesday, the GBA had received a total of 5,42,893 forms, of which 3,89,698 are yet to be processed.

Forms such as Form 6, Form 7 and Form 8 received up to September 23, the deadline for the claims and objections period, will be disposed of before October 22.

SIR in Delhi: disposals of Form 7 nearly six times those of Form 6

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

For every Form 6 application for inclusion in Delhi's electoral roll disposed of during the ongoing claims and objections phase of the special intensive revision (SIR), nearly six Form 7 applications seeking objections to the inclusion of names or their deletion from the draft roll have been cleared, data accessed by *The Hindu* showed.

According to the weekly constituency-wise forms disposal report, only 569 Form 6 applications were disposed of between August 31 and October 4. In comparison, 3,209 Form 7 applications were cleared during the same five-week period covered by the data. More than two-thirds of these Form 7 applications, or 2,352, were disposed of in the last two weeks alone, while no Form 6 application was disposed of last week.

Since the claims and objections phase began on August 31, 1.94 lakh applications seeking enrolment and 5,431 forms seeking deletion of names have been received so far, according to data from Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar's office.

The data also showed that 2.12 lakh Form 6 and 51,747 Form 7 applications had already been received before the claims and objections period began, between June 16 and August 30.

The claims and objections period ends on October 30, while disposal of



Only 569 Form 6 applications were disposed of in Delhi between August 31 and October 4. FILE PHOTO

the applications and notices has to be completed by November 30. The final roll is set to be published on December 4.

During the claims and objections period, an Indian citizen aged 18 or above can submit Form 6 to seek inclusion of their name in the final SIR roll, either as a first-time voter or if their name was left out of the draft roll published on August 31. An elector can simultaneously file Form 7 to object to or seek deletion of another elector's name from the roll.

Once an objection is received, a poll official serves a notice on the concerned elector, giving them 15 days to respond before any action is taken. A Booth Level Officer (BLO) is also required under the rules to verify the address and make three attempts to deliver the notice. For Form 6 applications, a BLO is assigned to conduct physical verification and submit a report, based on which a decision is taken.

Queries were sent to Mr. Kumar's office over the lower rate of Form 6 disposal compared with Form 7, but no replies were received till the time of going to press.

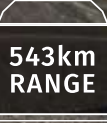
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CAPITAL
PROTEST

Opposition MPs from at least 19 parties turned out in full force to demand the scrapping of the SIR of electoral rolls and sacking of CEC Gyanesh Kumar



SP chief Akhilesh Yadav; Mamata Trinamool Congress's Abhishek Banerjee; MPs from various Oppn. parties staging a demonstration in central Delhi; A.A. Rahim of CPI(M); and RJD's Manoj Kumar Jha. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA, ANI

INBRIEF

J&K Apni Party leader backs Mufti's 'collective approach' call

Senior J&K Apni Party (JKAP) leader Rafi Ahmad Mir on Tuesday welcomed rival Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) president Mehbooba Mufti's call for a collective approach to address the political aspirations of people in the UT. Mr. Mir, a former PDP legislator from Pahalgam who switched to Altaf Bukhari's JKAP after 2019, said, "I welcome Mehbooba Mufti's call. I have been advocating this for a long time. Jammu and Kashmir cannot afford to speak to Delhi in fragmented voices when the issues before us concern the future of the entire generation." It's rare for JKAP to lend support to the PDP, which saw a vertical split under Mr. Bukhari in 2019.

Seven killed as speeding car rams truck in Bhavnagar

Seven persons died after their car rammed a parked trailer truck on a highway in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district on Tuesday, said the police. The victims were travelling from Bhavnagar to Alang, where they worked at a shipyard, Superintendent of Police Nitesh Pandey said. The accident occurred on the service road along the Bhavnagar-Somnath national highway near Trapaj village in Talaja taluka of the district around 10 a.m. when the speeding car crashed into the stationary trailer, said Mr. Pandey. An investigation into the incident is under way, the officer added.

Badal flags off drive to take feedback for poll manifesto

Press Trust of India
GIDDERBAHA (PUNJAB)

Shiromani Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal on Tuesday launched his party's 'Punjab Bachao' campaign by visiting houses in Doda village in Gidderbaha to elicit suggestions for the party's election manifesto, which he assured would reflect people's voice.

Mr. Badal said people told him that they wanted an end to the drug menace in the State.

The Assembly election in Punjab is likely to be held early next year.

Telling voters that Akali Dal leaders and workers would visit them and take their feedback for the manifesto, Mr. Badal said, "We want to make a *janta* manifesto." He added that manifestos should be given the status of a legal document to ensure that all parties abide by their promises or face disqualification.

CBI books six, including OSD to Mann, in 'corruption' case

FIR registered to investigate allegations of 'influencing' postings of IAS, IPS officers, revenue and property disputes, says probe agency; ED, CBI being misused ahead of Assembly election, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

A day after the Punjab and Haryana High Court directed the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) to probe corruption allegations linked to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's office, the investigating agency on Tuesday registered an FIR and booked six persons, including Rajbir Ghuman, the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the CM.

The CBI conducted raids at eight locations, including the CM's camp office. Mr. Mann alleged that Central probe agencies were being misused ahead of the Assembly poll.

The allegations made by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in communications to Punjab Police between July 24 and August 12



Rajbir Ghuman, the OSD to Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann. X/@RAJBIRGHUMANAAP

against public servants and private individuals linked to the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government include corruption in transfers and postings, policy manipulation and cash for tenders.

Those booked are two public servants and alleged middlemen and associates. "The FIR has been registered to investigate the allegations of corruption against the OSD to Punjab CM and his associates for influencing and manipulating postings of officers in-

cluding that of IAS and IPS officers, departmental proceedings, matters pertaining to policy formulation, administrative approvals, tender conditions, licensing matters, land use conversion matters, property disputes, revenue and land related issues in lieu of pecuniary benefits," the CBI stated in a release.

It added that the accused purportedly accessed and provided drafts of orders and policies to private individuals before their issuance. "Extensive coordinated searches were conducted at eight locations across Chandigarh, Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala, Sangrur and Jalandhar at premises connected with the accused persons during which incriminating evidence such as laptops, mobile phones and documents were seized," said the CBI.

In an X post, the CM wrote: "A CBI raid was conducted at my camp office. Now, the ED and CBI will be misused to defame the Punjab government and me. The BJP is rattled by the love being received from the people."

'CBI not sent by Centre'

Reacting sharply to his remark, former BJP Punjab chief Sunil Jakhar said, "The CBI has not been sent by the Government of India. It has been ordered by the Hon'ble High Court to investigate the loot of Punjab under your watch."

Punjab's Leader of the Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa said, "The irony is hard to miss: the place that symbolised Delhi's remote control over Punjab is now under the CBI scanner."

SC TO HEAR PUNJAB'S PLEA
» PAGE 10



Amit Shah

Amit Shah likely to visit Manipur in October: CM

Press Trust of India
IMPHAL

Manipur Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh on Tuesday said Union Home Minister Amit Shah is likely to visit the State in October, though the "exact date has not been fixed".

Interacting with media-persons after a Cabinet meeting, Mr. Singh said, "We resolved to express heartfelt gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi for completing 25 years in public service and to thank him for his special attention to Manipur and the Northeast."

'Beyond self-reliance': Rajnath flags off Surya, India' first indigenous fleet support ship

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched the Navy's first indigenous fleet support ship (FSS-I), named *Surya*, and laid the keel for the fifth vessel of the series, FSS-5, at Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday.

The ceremony was attended by Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, Secretary (Defence Production) Sanjeev Kumar, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Eastern Naval Command Vice Admiral Sanjay Bhal-la, HSL CMD Rear Admiral C. Raghuram, and other dignitaries.

The Minister urged Indian shipyards to look



Rajnath Singh addressing the gathering at the launch of the fleet support ship, Surya, in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday. V. RAJU

beyond self-reliance towards global competitiveness, aiming to serve international markets, build a presence in marine technology, and provide advanced ship repair services.

The massive Fleet Support Ship (FSS) initiative is backed by a landmark ₹19,000-crore contract between the Ministry of Defence and HSL to con-

struct five indigenous auxiliary vessels.

The FSS platform, with 82% indigenous content, serves as a floating supply powerhouse, engineered to sustain protracted, high-intensity naval engagements and battle groups far from home ports.

Its internal storage holds up to 20,000 tonnes of high-speed diesel, 2,500 tonnes of aviation turbine

fuel, fresh water, alongside dry cargo containers for ammunition and spares. It can simultaneously transfer fuel, stores, and personnel to multiple warships to maintain continuous high-seas deployment.

Massive overhaul

To execute this mega-project, HSL underwent a massive infrastructural overhaul, highlighted by the inauguration of its newly modernised Slipway No. 4 and a 300-tonne Goliath crane. These upgrades expand covered building dock capacity to 80,000 DWT, enabling construction up to 45,000 DWT. Incorporating 82% indigenous content, the FSS programme secures strategic autonomy and reinforces Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan, the mission to make India self-reliant.

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A tribal youth body in Arunachal Pradesh has asked the government to withdraw the Central Armed Police Forces and State Police personnel deployed to allegedly quell protests against the pre-feasibility report and related surveys for a proposed mega hydropower project.

The All Adi Youth Association condemned the situation arising out of clashes between the protesters and security personnel at various places in Siang and Upper Siang districts over the past few days.

The association's secretary, Okut Taki, told journalists in the State's capital, Itanagar, on Tuesday that the "militarisation" of the Siang river belt has brought law-and-order



Anti-dam protesters say the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project would destroy swathes of wildlife habitats. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

concerns for locals.

Pointing to the protests and frequent clashes, he rejected the Bharatiya Janata Party government's claim that most families who would be affected by the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project favoured the pre-feasibility report.

The National Hydroelectric Power Corporation Limited is pursuing the Siang Upper Multipurpose Pro-

ject, estimated to generate at least 11,000 megawatt (MW) of hydropower.

The Centre and the State government insist that the project would counter the 60,000 MW Medog hydropower station that China is building on the Yarlung Tsangpo, which flows into Arunachal Pradesh as the Siang.

The Siang meets the Dibang and Lohit further

downstream in Assam to form the Brahmaputra.

"The Adis have traditionally resolved disputes through customary institutions such as the Kebang. The deployment of heavy security forces is not the appropriate way to address differences over the project," Mr. Taki said.

'Not all in favour'

The association alleged that the memoranda of understanding the government signed with the villagers "in favour" of the pre-feasibility report did not reflect the views of all 27 villages that will be affected by the project.

Anti-dam protesters say the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project would spell disaster for the Adi community and destroy swathes of forestlands and wildlife habitats.

Traffic snarls at Delhi's brand-new flyover persist week after opening

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

A week after the Barapullah Phase-III flyover was thrown open with a promise of cutting the journey from Mayur Vihar to AIIMS in Delhi to just 15 minutes, commuters are spending more than an hour inching through traffic on the newly opened corridor. On Tuesday, traffic queues stretching over 2 km brought the 3.5-km stretch to a crawl, with commuters reporting waiting times of 70-100 minutes.

Videos shared by commuters showed vehicles packed bumper-to-bumper on the elevated road, with even ambulances



Traffic queues stretching over 2 km brought the 3.5-km stretch to a crawl. FILE PHOTO

caught in the snarl.

"I have been stuck on the flyover for the past 25 minutes in a traffic jam," a commuter travelling from Noida towards New Delhi told *The Hindu* around 10.30 a.m. When contacted an hour later, the commuter said they were still stuck in the traffic and that

it had taken more than 70 minutes to get off the flyover.

Another commuter described the stretch as "completely blocked", saying traffic had remained stationary for nearly an hour and questioning the absence of traffic personnel on that particular stretch.

Meanwhile, the Public Works Department (PWD) on Tuesday placed jersey barriers at the merger point, a police officer said.

"The jersey barriers, which are concrete or plastic road dividers used to channel vehicles, are aimed at preventing vehicles from joining the existing corridor at an abrupt

angle, allowing traffic to merge more smoothly and reducing the sudden slowing that has been contributing to the bottleneck," the officer said.

The traffic police also deployed personnel at the merger point to manually regulate the flow, allowing traffic from each side to pass one stream at a time to ease the bottleneck, he added.

Redesign sought

In a letter dated October 1, the Delhi traffic police asked the PWD to modify the merger near Sundial Park. The letter was based on a joint inspection conducted by senior traffic police officers and PWD of-

ficials on September 30 to examine traffic movement and the geometry of the new flyover and its adjoining stretches.

The traffic police found that the new flyover joins the existing corridor through a relatively sharp, almost rectangular alignment rather than a gradual curve. This forces traffic to merge abruptly and creates a bottleneck at the junction.

The issue was already evident within days of the flyover opening. Barapullah Phase-III was opened to public traffic on September 29 and by the following evenings, queues had stretched up to 3.5 km.

"Travelling to Bhikaji

Cama Place from Ghaziabad was a nightmare. Traffic was stuck on the new Barapullah flyover for more than 30 minutes in the morning," a commuter said. Suggesting that congestion could be reduced by discouraging unnecessary traffic, the commuter said the stretch could even be made a toll road.

Traffic pattern

The traffic police have also written to Google seeking an update of the traffic pattern on the new road. South Delhi Deputy Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Sandeep Gupta said the company had sought seven to 10 days to incorporate sufficient traffic data.

Maharashtra Cabinet clears higher allowances for SC, ST students

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Maharashtra Cabinet on Tuesday approved a number of proposals, including higher allowances under scholarship and hostel schemes for students from Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) communities.

Under the Bharat Ratna Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Swadhar Yojana, students from SC and Navbuddha categories who are eligible for government hostels but did not get admission will now receive a total annual

grant of ₹80,000, up from ₹60,000.

The revised amount applies to those pursuing higher education in Mumbai City, Mumbai Suburb, Pune, Pimpri-Chinchwad, Navi Mumbai, Thane and Nagpur.

A similar hike has been cleared for students from ST communities under the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Swayam Yojana.

The Cabinet also approved the Mukhyamantri Shaurya Padak for police personnel for acts of bravery and a compensation policy for custodial deaths.



SAGARMANTHAN

— THE GREAT OCEANS DIALOGUE —

“



-Shri Narendra Modi, Prime Minister

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Stefanos Gkikas
Deputy Minister, Maritime Affairs and
Insular Policy, Greece *



U Tun Lu
Deputy Minister of Transport, Myanmar



Astrid Bergmål
State Secretary, Ministry of Foreign Affairs,
Norway



75
COUNTRIES



165
SPEAKERS



70+
SESSIONS



Let there be light
The Nobel Laureates for Medicine
illuminated how the brain works

The first of the Nobel announcements has come, heralding the season of celebrating the fruits of the perennial human endeavour to know more and use that knowledge to benefit people. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine went jointly to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegeman and Georg Nagel “for their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics”. True to Alfred Bernhard Nobel’s aim of annually recognising those who have “conferred the greatest benefit to humankind”, this year’s Nobel went to people who shone a light, literally, on the brain, providing a quantum leap in understanding how it functions. In essence, if the brain is a puppeteer pulling the strings, the body is the marionette. The dexterity of the puppeteer is obvious, but her methods, often not. It is this that the Nobel trio sought to explain with optogenetics – making it possible to show how nerve cells communicate with each other, and the body, regulating memory, emotions and bodily functions. It allowed mapping the brain in ways that were previously impossible. As most often in work that the Nobel acknowledges and honours, there was rich collaboration across continents in advancing optogenetics. Peter Hegemann wondered what enabled *Chlamydomonas*, a single-celled alga, to swim towards a light source; Georg Nagel went on to discover an algal protein that can be illuminated with blue light to open a channel within, allowing charged ions to flow into the cell and create electrical impulses. Karl Deisseroth transformed the protein into a light-controlled switch for nerve cells. Practically, today, scientists use harmless viral agents to deliver genes for light-sensitive proteins into specific target cells. Then they deliver precise pulses of light, activating the channels, allowing research to study the patterns. In the decades since the laureates described their work, researchers have gone on to use optogenetics to reveal neural circuits governing specific memories, feelings and behaviours relevant to neurological and psychiatric disorders. It laid the groundwork for clinical treatments targeting conditions including Alzheimer’s and addiction. Researchers are even using the method in attempts to restore sight.

As technology facilitates easier pathways to translating scientific research that happens in labs into practical therapies, diagnostics and health-care practices that could ameliorate human health or protect it from illness, it is also important for nations to find ways to ensure that the fruits of such research actually reach all the people who might benefit from it, irrespective of their location or station in life.

Break the chain
India must focus on cutting
transmission of leprosy

While the prevalence of leprosy among adults and children and the grade-2 disability rate have dropped in India over the last decade, its continued transmission in many pockets constrains India’s ability to meet targets outlined in the National Strategic Plan (NSP) and Roadmap for Leprosy 2023-2027. By 2005, the national prevalence had dropped to under 1 case per 10,000 people, prompting the World Health Organization (WHO) to declare that India had “eliminated [leprosy] as a public health problem”. However, the government became complacent and allowed the folding of the leprosy surveillance programme into the general health system. Multi-drug treatment regimens also shortened the time for which patients remained formally registered, allowing prevalence to fall and transmission to continue. Disability due to leprosy began to rise in the early 2010s, prompting door-to-door screening. Today, the NSP is right to focus on cutting transmission, in line with WHO. Since India’s children accounted for around 46% of all cases reported among children in 2025, the two programmes need to move in tandem. The drop in disease burden has also been highly uneven – Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, and Maharashtra bear disproportionate shares of the national burden. According to the 2025-26 National Leprosy Elimination Programme report, only 148 districts have achieved ‘interruption of transmission’ (pending field verification) against the projected 300.

In 2025-26, workers screened more than 70 crore people in highly endemic areas, where 24,367 cases were detected, and ASHA workers flagged nearly 40 lakh suspected cases, with 48,027 cases confirmed. Workers also administered single-dose rifampicin as post-exposure prophylaxis to 91.1% of those 16.9 lakh likely to have come in contact. The government has operationalised digital surveillance and is deliberating on using the MIP vaccine to accelerate pathogen clearance in patients deemed highly infectious. One persistent set of lacunae pertains to care: research has shown nerve damage in many patients by the time they sought care, largely due to the stigma, while many clinical practitioners are unfamiliar with leprosy’s pathology or misdiagnose it as a skin condition. Reading these realities together, the state should double down on interrupting transmission and make prevalence a secondary outcome. It should also resist the temptation to ease detection or revise its elimination targets – the 2025-26 report says the overall incidence overshot projections by 41%, incidence among children by 91.6%, and the grade-2 disability rate by 34% – and instead redouble its investments to meet the extant 2026-27 projections. Finally, it should commit its augmented efforts at locations and social settings where both late diagnosis and transmission remain trenchant.

In my 48 years in public life, I have seen political parties rise and fall. I have seen leaders emerge with great promise and fade away. I have seen governments change, economies transform and technology alter our lives beyond recognition. One lesson has become increasingly clear to me: ultimately, leadership matters.

In today’s world, technology, knowledge, capital and ideas are freely available. But the true differentiator for nations is leadership – one with vision, integrity, credibility and the ability to execute.

On October 7, 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi completes 25 uninterrupted years in executive office – first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and, since 2014, as the Prime Minister of India. It is a remarkable journey of leadership sustained by public trust. Through changing circumstances, Mr. Modi has remained remarkably consistent in his purpose: the development of India and the empowerment of its people.

The world around us has been turbulent. We have witnessed a global financial crisis, a once-in-a-century pandemic, wars, geopolitical realignments, technological disruption and economic uncertainty. Several democracies have experienced frequent changes of leadership and consequent policy uncertainty. Through all this, India has remained steady at the wheel and an oasis of economic hope.

Leadership built on trust

Such stable leadership cannot sustain itself for 25 years merely through politics. It requires trust. Mr. Modi has earned that trust through an established track record, impeccable personal integrity and tireless self-discipline. In today’s world, public leaders effectively live in glass houses. Every decision and every action can be seen and questioned. To retain the confidence of people over decades under such scrutiny is an achievement in itself.

Mr. Modi brings a unique ability to understand people’s aspirations, translate them into action and communicate those results back to the people.

The results are visible. Over the last decade, India’s National Highway network has expanded from about 91,287 kilometres in 2014 to more than 1,46,000 km. The airport network has grown from 74 airports in 2014 to over 160. Railway electrification has accelerated dramatically. India’s installed renewable-energy capacity has now reached nearly 296 GW,



N. Chandrababu Naidu

The Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years in leadership reflect India’s transformation and its rising national ambitions

The China-U.S. rapprochement

The world, understandably, has been watching carefully the unfolding summitry between the United States and Chinese Presidents over the last several months. It had been a long time between drinks: just under a decade in the case of President Donald Trump’s last visit to Beijing in late 2017; and just over a decade since President Xi Jinping stood on the White House lawns in 2015 with President Barack Obama.

Whereas now it is four summits in little more than six months: Beijing, Washington, Shenzhen and then Miami. Now it is everything, everywhere, all at once, with some speculating that we are seeing the birth of a new G-2.

More a new phase

It is natural for the world to wonder what, if anything, has fundamentally changed in the strategic architecture of the U.S.-China relationship. It is always hard to parse the difference between the language and theatre of politics and diplomacy, and what is actually happening on the ground.

Despite the pomp and circumstance in both the Beijing and Washington summits, the reality is that nothing much has changed in the fundamentals of the relationship. Whatever public language might be used, the U.S. and China remain fully engaged in an all-pervasive strategic competition on which of them will emerge as the dominant Indo-Pacific and then global power for the 21st century – militarily, in the economy, technology, foreign policy as well as the underlying ideological contest between democratic capitalism and China’s alternative authoritarian model.

Whatever the diplomatic surround sound might be, core decision-makers in both Washington and Beijing continue to have a deeply realist view of this ongoing strategic contest – or what the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) has long called the “struggle for the future of the international order”. Strategic competition is not going away. The real question is whether that competition can be managed within the framework of some mutually acceptable rules of the road. Or whether it is left unmanaged with a rolling risk of crisis, conflict or even war.

What the U.S. and China appear to be doing is moving towards an imperfect form of bilateral management mechanism. This process began in



Kevin Rudd

Global President and CEO of Asia Society, New York, and the 26th Prime Minister of Australia

There is no ‘G-2’ yet in U.S.-China relations -- Washington and Beijing may manage their tensions, but their strategic competition remains entrenched

including large hydro, with solar alone crossing 168 GW. Infrastructure today is being conceived not as isolated projects but as an integrated national network through initiatives such as PM Gati Shakti (Prime Minister Gati Shakti – National Master Plan for Multi-Modal Connectivity).

At the same time, India’s welfare architecture has expanded basic security and dignity. Around 80 crore people receive free foodgrains, including five kilograms a person per month for eligible priority households. Tapwater coverage in rural homes has risen from about 17% in 2019 to over 82%. An estimated 24.8 crore Indians moved out of multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23. The significance lies not only in the scale of these programmes, but in their reach. Technology has enabled the State to deliver basic entitlements more directly, transparently and at a scale that was once unimaginable.

Technology in nation-building

Mr. Modi has a deep appreciation of technology and its role in transforming India. He understands emerging technologies, adopts them early and, more importantly, applies them to nation-building. He sees technology as a tool to improve governance, empower people, create opportunities and accelerate development. India’s Digital Public Infrastructure has shown how technology can democratise access to banking, welfare and public services at unprecedented scale. This deep appreciation of technology has enabled him to launch a host of frontier policies aimed at making India take a giant leap and put it in the league of global tech titans. India’s quantum mission, semi-conductor mission, and a host of Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes across electronics and advanced manufacturing are instances of this vision.

India’s space sector is another great example. For decades, India’s extraordinary capabilities in space were centred overwhelmingly around government. By opening the sector to private enterprise and creating an enabling ecosystem, the government has unleashed a new generation of entrepreneurs. Companies such as Skyroot Aerospace, Pixxel, Agnikul, Dhruva and Bellatrix demonstrate what young Indians can achieve when regulation gives way to innovation.

As a Chief Minister first and then a Prime Minister, Mr. Modi has a strong belief in “Team India”. He knows that India cannot be transformed from Delhi alone. Growth needs to be decentralised with States and cities

May last year with the regularisation of the political channel between U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng. This followed the imposition of trade-destroying tariffs of 125% in April 2025 by Mr. Trump, which were then promptly matched by 125% from Mr. Xi. To preserve their respective national economic interests, both sides then walked back from the brink of a full trade war. Since then, Mr. Bessent, Mr. He and their teams have now met eight times – on average every two months. And after a tumultuous decade across every dimension of the relationship, the Bessent-He channel has indeed had a stabilising effect.

Beijing’s push for stability

China in particular has sought stability as it moves into 2027. Later next year, the CCP convenes the 21st Party Congress when Mr. Xi will be appointed to a record fourth term as General Secretary and where he hopes to appoint a fresh phalanx of personal loyalists to the party’s most senior positions. While Mr. Xi’s authority remains unchallenged, he will want as benign a domestic economic environment as possible.

China’s dilemma is that the domestic drivers of economic growth are performing poorly. Private domestic consumption is in the doldrums. Private residential construction is into its sixth year of recession. Private fixed capital investment is also flat-lining. That leaves public investment (i.e., China’s gargantuan techno-industrial strategy) and net exports as the two primary pistons driving the Chinese growth engine.

The last thing Beijing wants is for the U.S. to resume a full-scale trade war which Mr. Trump is perfectly capable of doing. Just look at what he did in 2018 and in 2025. China therefore has been doubling down on its “stability narrative” with the U.S. Its new concept of “constructive strategic stability” is about maximising “cooperation”, managing “competition within defined bounds”, while also managing “strategic differences”, which is code language for Taiwan. In China’s conceptual universe, if these three pillars are properly attended to, then the cardinal objective is achieved: stability.

It is an elegant schemata. It is China’s effort at “managed strategic competition” with the U.S. Moreover, the U.S. has formally accepted this framework in official readouts from the Beijing

competing. His emphasis on cooperative and competitive federalism has given States a larger role in India’s development journey.

India’s place in the world

In his tenure, India’s stature abroad has also changed profoundly. Today, India’s voice is heard with greater respect on global platforms. India protects its national interest while engaging with different centres of global power, preserves strategic autonomy while building deeper partnerships, and projects its civilisational confidence as a modern, technology-driven nation. India today is among the world’s fastest-growing major economies. But I believe the most consequential phase of our journey is still ahead.

Few countries possess India’s combination of strengths. It has a demographic dividend, an extraordinary entrepreneurial energy, technological capabilities and a young generation that is ambitious, confident and increasingly connected to global opportunity. If we make the right decisions now, the benefits will last for centuries. This is why leadership at this moment assumes historic importance.

Mr. Modi’s 25 years in executive leadership have demonstrated the qualities such a moment demands. The Narendra Modi who became Chief Minister of Gujarat on October 7, 2001, and the Prime Minister leading India today are connected by the same clarity of purpose and unshakeable belief in India’s potential.

Twenty-five years have established his record. The next 20 years can establish India’s place in history. The true significance of these 25 years, however, will be judged by what they enable India to achieve next. Mr. Modi has shifted the country’s development trajectory – from incrementalism to ambition, from hesitation to confidence, and from managing limitations to believing in possibilities. I am confident that the direction he has set and the institutional momentum created during these years will help India realise its ambition of Viksit Bharat 2047 and reclaim its place among the world’s leading nations.

Few leaders are given the opportunity to shape a generation. Rarer still are those who can shape the destiny of a nation. After 25 years of leadership, Mr. Modi’s greatest contribution may ultimately be that he made India believe once again in the scale of its own possibilities – and gave the nation the leadership to turn that belief into reality.

Washington Summits. But the U.S. has added the explicit caveat that any such bilateral framework be both “fair and reciprocal”.

For Washington realists, that is enough to drive a bus through any “constructive strategic stability” narrative on any day of the week. Furthermore, Beijing would be wildly optimistic if it concluded that Donald Trump is likely to be constrained in his future freedom of manoeuvre because of some grand, overarching foreign policy narrative. The President just does not operate that way.

A fragile truce

What concerns China most is if what is called the “Busan Tariff Truce” agreed to last October falls apart. That original 12-month truce has only been extended two months. If the U.S. concludes that China has not been helpful on U.S. agricultural exports, or in the normalisation of the critical minerals and rare earths trade with the U.S., there is a real risk that the Busan Truce collapses. And if the European Union were to move in the same direction on tariffs given the crisis in European manufacturing, the consequences for an export-dependent Chinese economy would be large.

For all these reasons, both tactical and strategic, the U.S.-China relationship remains deeply fragile. Even if the Busan Truce extends beyond December, the effective general U.S. tariff rate against China will remain much, much higher than, for example, India’s. Beyond trade, there also remains a formidable array of export controls on critical technologies, including world-class chips where China remains several years behind the U.S. And that leaves to one side a bilateral foreign investment regime which remains deeply restrictive at both ends of the relationship.

Therefore, breathless reporting about an emerging “G2” between the U.S. and China in some sort of global strategic condominium is fanciful. Whatever tactical accommodations may occur in the trade relationship, the fundamental nature of the strategic competition between Washington and Beijing continues. Remember it was Donald Trump, on the very eve of Mr. Xi’s state visit to Washington DC, who stated, “Whoever wins in AI, wins.” That is Xi Jinping’s view too. That does not exactly sound like an emerging G-2 to me.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Transparency, poll trust

The Supreme Court of India’s notice to the Election Commission of India over the “modified” Form 6 highlights a simple point: any change to voter registration must follow due legal procedure and be made public. Citizens providing correct details

should be able to register without hurdles. Transparency in the Election Commission is essential to restoring public trust.

Sankalp Gupta,

Dhenkanal, Odisha

The Changes concerning voter registration and electoral rolls cannot be

treated as routine administrative matters when they directly affect citizens’ democratic rights. The Election Commission must ensure that every decision is transparent, accountable and supported by clear records. At the same time, allegations must be examined on the basis of

evidence rather than assumption. Public confidence in elections ultimately depends on institutions being open to scrutiny.

Albin Thekkethala,

Kallur, Thrissur, Kerala

Medicine Nobel

Many of the most significant

advances in medicine start with questions that appear to have nothing to do with the field. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine is a striking instance. This is something that India should take note of. Basic science requires patience, freedom, and continuous support — a

question which seems unclear in a laboratory at the present time could end up forming the basis of tomorrow’s medicine.

Dr. Yash Javeri,

Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

Why charging for UPI changes the math

In the decade since its launch, India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has evolved from a promising digital experiment into critical economic infrastructure. Against this backdrop, the Union Finance Ministry has notified that the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) will operationalise a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on specified merchant transactions above ₹2,000 from October 15. While consumers will not be charged directly, this marks a significant departure from UPI's zero-MDR model for merchants. While the reasoning is understandable, considering the costs to run UPI, one question deserves an answer: what has UPI cost India, and what has it saved?

The costs are easy to see as servers, security and fraud controls show up on balance sheets, while the savings are scattered across the economy. For example, take a small shopkeeper. Before digital payments, taking cash meant counting notes, keeping change, guarding the till and making trips to the bank, with the added risk of theft. UPI removed most of that, with customers also saving themselves a few trips to the ATM. Further, banks now handle less physical cash, businesses reconcile accounts faster, lenders are able to read a small trader's cash flow from digital records, and most importantly, the government gets a trail that helps with formalisation and tax compliance. None of this is revenue to UPI; it is spread across banks, consumers and the exchequer.

The case for MDR is that the payments ecosystem needs a steady income to



Amerikai V. Narayanan

National Spokesperson of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), a certified public accountant (CPA) and a certified management accountant (CMA)

maintain and expand UPI, which is a fair point. Yet this logic assumes that most of UPI's cost should be recovered from the transactions on it; the wider benefits are not accounted for. Every payment that moves from cash to UPI cuts handling costs elsewhere while every merchant who joins adds to formalisation. Further, the increase in UPI users makes the network more useful to those already on it. India has acted on this logic before: the government approved ₹1,500 crore in 2024-25 alone to incentivise low-value merchant transactions, with the view that moving cash through digital networks was worth paying for.

Balancing benefits

On September 28, the Supreme Court, while declining to stay the levy, asked the Centre, the RBI and the NPCI to explain, on affidavit, the legal basis for the levy, including whether the MDR was a tax or a fee. In response, the government stated that nothing reaches the exchequer and that the money was a settlement between banks and service providers. This answers the legal question but not the economic one – what is India giving up?

Consider a highway between an industrial region and a port. A toll can be perfectly reasonable, but toll collections say little about the highway's real return, which is the faster movement of goods and the businesses that grow with it. A port is similar; while container fees pay for operations, its larger contribution is the trade that it enables. UPI also deserves the same lens. Any plan to recover its maintenance bill should ask what happens to the activity it supports once a

toll is introduced. That calculation is largely missing from the MDR debate.

MDR might raise money that lets banks and payment providers invest more in resilience and expansion. But it would also lead to a change in behaviour. Some merchants may prefer cash for transactions while others may nudge customers towards a different payment instrument. When payments slip back to cash, the costs UPI had removed come back such as handling, reconciliation, cash logistics, and less digital visibility. Some of the formalisation gains go too. If ₹100 collected in MDR causes more than ₹100 of economic value to disappear elsewhere, the payment system ends up better funded and the country poorer.

Additionally, UPI and RuPay had helped India build a domestic payments ecosystem at the expense of global card networks. The USTR had earlier called India's zero-MDR policy a market-access barrier for Visa and Mastercard; these players now stand to gain from any drift back to cards. A lasting domestic advantage should not be conceded for trade terms that can later be revised.

A network that millions of Indians rely on has to be secure, resilient and able to grow. The harder question is what "self-sustaining" should mean. The test for the new toll should be straightforward: does it increase India's overall economic return from UPI after accounting for the behaviour it may change and the wider benefits the network creates? This is the question policymakers should answer.

If ₹100 collected in MDR causes more than ₹100 of economic value to disappear elsewhere, the payment system ends up better funded and the country poorer

Indian research can shape the world

People fret about the buses India has missed in its technological growth. The list is familiar: aircraft, advanced weapons, new materials, and biotechnology. In each, we look at what others built decades ago and ask why we did not. There is value in this introspection, and there is danger. The value is that it forces us to ask whether our systems can be streamlined and enabled. Catching up is not a bad thing. Much of the world's industrial history is a history of catching up. The danger is that catch-up-itis can become a habit. If our ambition is always defined by what someone else has already done, we will always arrive late, pay for licences and know-how, and build on foundations laid elsewhere. The costs of technological catch-up are a heavy burden, and they recur with every new wave.

There is a better question to ask, and it arises from a tectonic change in the relationship between science and technology. By science, we mean discovery, curiosity, the effort to explain the universe, and the development of abstract ideas in mathematics. By technology, we mean the development of tools that enable humans to transform the world. For much of history these were treated as separate enterprises, with technology following science at a distance, sometimes by a century.

However, over the past 50 years or so we have increasingly seen fundamental research and application sewn together at the hip. Much of our understanding of how genes are regulated came from studying viruses that infect bacteria. More recently,



K. VijayRaghavan

Former Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India and chairs Ashoka University's Science Advisory Council



Archish Mittal

Vice-President, Iron Pillar

studying how bacteria defend themselves gave us CRISPR technology within just a few years, which has an extraordinary range of applications. Today, the distance and time from curiosity to application are short. This shift lets thinking and training lead, and it shows that investing in fundamental research will enable leading than playing catch-up. The bus we need to board is the next one, and it has not yet left.

Get on the bus first

For science from India to have global impact by developing transformative technologies, four things need to be addressed.

First, invest in high-quality education at scale. The features of AI that democratise access to learning allow us to reach millions of students poorly served by our moribund institutions, and to bypass those institutions where necessary. But learning science requires doing science. Hundreds of experimental "foundries" in engineering, physics, biology, chemistry and math should be created; places where young people work with real instruments on real problems.

Second, national laboratories need to be liberated from insularity. The bulk of our national labs are currently poorly accessible to researchers, students and companies outside their walls. This can easily change, benefiting both labs and universities. All national labs need to be organised around three zones: green for open interaction, amber for collaboration, and red for strategic work. Much of what India's labs do belong in the green and amber zones. Third is flexibility. Many

say we are a low-trust society and that our regulators should trust our research system more and be more flexible. The response to this is to point out that trust is low because compliance with guidelines is poor, necessitating onerous rules. However, India does have many high-quality islands of excellence in universities, institutes and laboratories. These institutions do comply with the rules and regulations, and should be freed from the weight of General Financial Rules compliance, a weight few other countries place on their scientists. Accountability should be measured by outcomes, and not by procedure at every step. Flexibility can allow these institutions to leap ahead.

Fourth, our regulatory system still needs much reform. Approvals for research with biological materials and for clinical trials remain slow and unpredictable. The more hoops companies and researchers must jump through, the less likely small and medium-sized institutions are to succeed, since only those with deep pockets can afford the time and costs. Thus, high-quality, speedy regulation is important.

None of this is beyond us; they can be achieved step by step. Many are already doing so in pockets. What is missing is the decision to make those pockets the norm, and a few who dedicate themselves to this task. How long will it take to become a science-driven nation with global impact? If we improve just 10% in each sector, field, and every year, we will be nearly seven times better in 20 years.

Women are twice as likely to use public transport for work commute

Nearly 67% of all women who commuted to work relied on walking or buses or other public transport

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy
Gandla Sneha

The National Household Travel Survey (NHTS), which captures how people in India travel to the workplace, shows a clear gender divide in mobility and the modes used to travel to work. Data shows that women are twice as likely as men to commute to work using public transport such as buses or trains or on foot compared to men. Nearly 67% of all women who commuted to work relied on walking or buses or other public transport. This figure was only 33% for all men who commuted to work (Chart 1). In rural areas, more than half of all women who were working walked to their workplaces. However, a large share of men were dependent on two-wheelers.

While two-wheelers remained a major mode of transport for both men and women in urban areas, women were not solely reliant on two-wheelers.

A Statewise analysis shows that the share of women walking to work rather than relying on buses was higher than the national average in the central and northeastern States, including M.P., U.P. and Bihar (Chart 2) signifying low public transport availability. In southern States such as Kerala, the gap between women taking buses in rural and urban areas reduced significantly.

While women in urban areas also rely on other means such as autos and cars, they still take slightly longer than men to commute to work. In at least 13 major States, a higher share of men commuted to work in around 30 minutes compared to women (Chart 3).

The use of public transport reflects the cost of commuting too. Though women's expenditure on commute is lower than that of men in rural areas, the gap is reducing in urban areas (Chart 4).

The commute divide

Data for the charts were sourced from the National Household Travel Survey conducted by the National Statistics Office (NSO). The survey was conducted between July 2025 and June 2026 covering 2,84,769 rural and 2,07,254 urban households. The analysis pertains only to the share of workers aged 15 and above and a trip is defined as travel covering a distance of more than 1 km



Chart 1: The share of men, women and persons using different modes of transport to commute to work. Figures in %

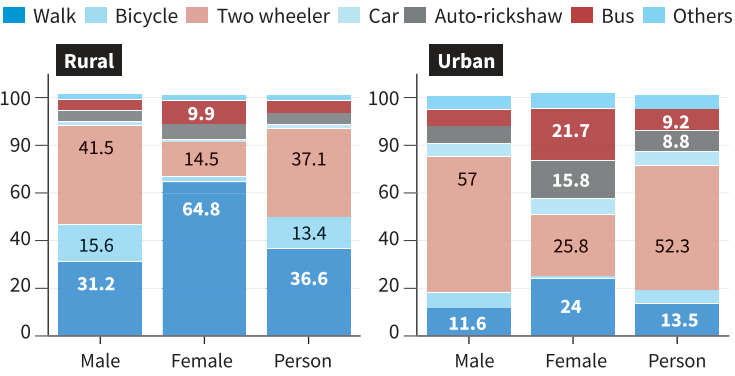


Chart 2: Share of women who either walked or used the bus as a primary mode of transport to commute to work. Data pertains to major States only. Figures in %

■ In States like M.P., U.P., Bihar and Chhattisgarh, rural women are overwhelmingly dependent on walking. For instance, in Madhya Pradesh, 88.7% of rural women walked and only 2.0% used the bus. This could signal either lack of access to public transport or proximity of workplaces

■ In Kerala, only 20.1% of rural women walked, while 48.6% used the bus. This is the highest share of rural women using the bus for their commute in the country. In general, the share of women walking to work reduces in urban areas

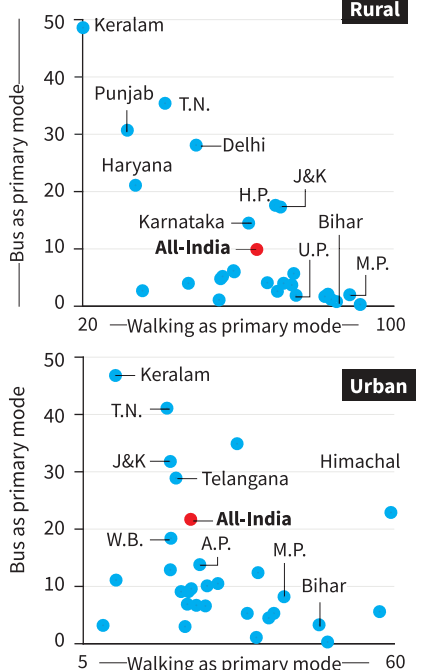


Chart 3: State-wise share of men and women who commute to work within 30 minutes. Figures in %

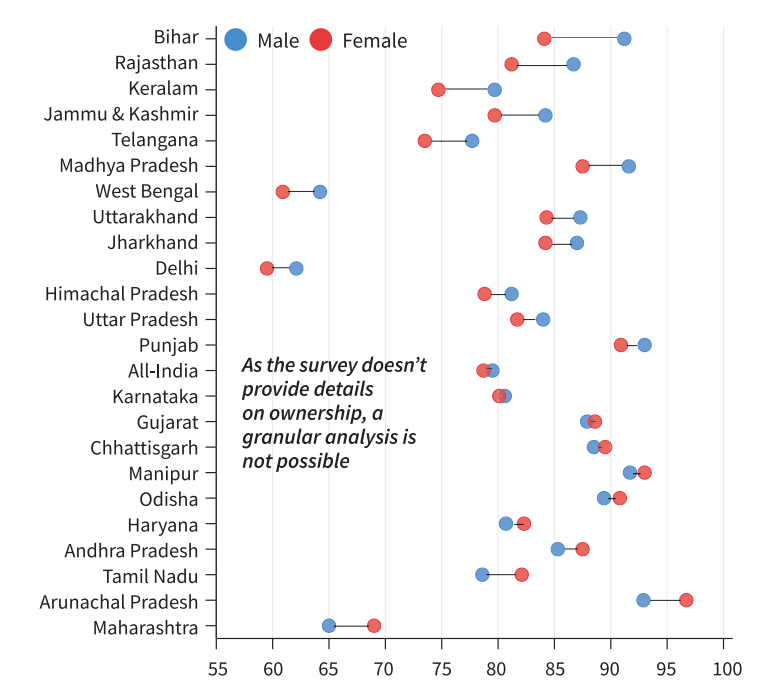
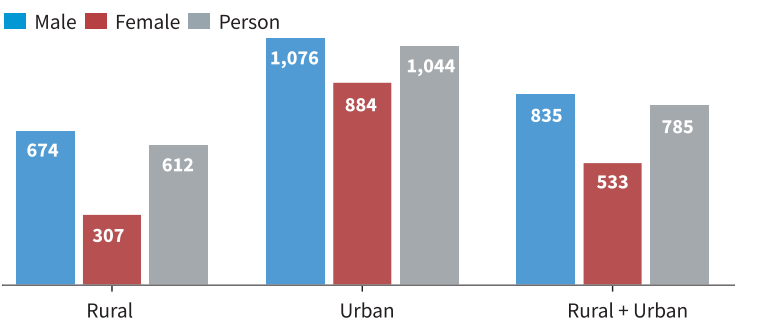


Chart 4: Average monthly cost of commuting to work for men, women and persons by type of area. Figures in ₹



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu**.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1976

'Aluminium conductors cause phone faults'

Hyderabad, October 6: Due to the extensive use of aluminium conductors, quite often "disconnection faults occur on the telephone lines", resulting in the telephones becoming 'dead', according to Mr. K.S. Krishnamurthy Rao, Sub-Divisional Officer, Telephones, at the Saifabad Exchange here.

In a paper presented at the seminar on "Improved Service to Telephone Users", organised by the Junior Engineers (Telcom) Association, Mr. Krishnamurthy Rao said an expert committee constituted by the Indian Post and Telegraphs Department had "discouraged" the use of aluminium conductors and suggested "reversion to copper". "If this is implemented, I am sure, we will be improving our services to a large extent", he said.

Presiding over the seminar, held at the Regional Telcom Training Centre on Abid Road, Prof Alladi Prabhakar, Head of Osmania University's Department of Electronics and Communication Engineering, called for an integrated telecommunication network which could deal not only with voice communication but also facsimile, video and other media. He emphasised the vital role of electronic switching in this regard.

In his paper, Mr. Krishnamurthy Rao observed that the maintenance aspect had not been forgotten by the department in the course of the vast expansion of telecommunication services.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1926

Fighting malaria in Indian plantations

London, October 6: Under the auspices of the Indian Tea Association, Sir Ronald Ross will leave for India on 29th October on board 'Rajpatanam'. He will travel to Calcutta via Malay States with the object of inspecting measures for the control of malaria, that are being carried out in the plantations in India and Malay States. While in Malay States, he will be the guest of Sir Watson. Sir Ronald Ross will unveil at Calcutta a commemorative tablet in his old laboratory at the Presidency General Hospital. He will also lecture at the Calcutta School of Tropical Medicine.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

India's data centre sector investment commitments

173 in \$ billion. India's data centre (DC) market added about 130 MW of new capacity in the first six months of 2026, while more than 200 MW is expected to go live in the second half of the year, CBRE said in a report released on Tuesday. Hyperscale and co-location investments accounted for close to 62% of the cumulative DC commitments. PTI

Amount Zambia will sign in U.S. five-year health deal

3.6 in \$ billion. Zambia will sign a revised health agreement with the U.S. that will not include contentious clauses committing the African nation to share data with the U.S. government. The U.S. has signed new bilateral health agreements with around two dozen African nations since last year, but some have pushed back on requirements to provide patient data. PTI

Indian crew members injured in ship hit by projectile in Hormuz

11 Eleven Indian crew members were injured on Tuesday after a Panama-flagged commercial vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz. The vessel, *MT On Peace*, carried 19 crew members, including 17 Indian nationals. The Ministry of External Affairs said continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a "cause of deep concern" for India. PTI

Ukrainian drones downed overnight, according to Russia

900 Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday. Unconfirmed reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. PTI

Students who received bicycles under Delhi's Vidya Vahini Yojana

18,000 Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday distributed bicycles to 581 Class 9 girl students under the government's Vidya Vahini Yojana, aimed at making the daily commute to school easier and promoting independence among girls. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The status of U.S. blockade on Cuba

U.S. blockade and decades-old embargo on Cuba have worsened the island's economic and humanitarian crisis, with fuel shortages disrupting electricity, food distribution, healthcare; as Havana seeks to ease the crisis, Trump administration's pressure and demand for regime change continue to constrain Cuba's options

WORLD INSIGHT

Srinivasan Ramani
Sambavi Parthasarathy

The story so far:

It has been nearly nine months since the U.S. President Donald Trump signed an executive order threatening tariffs on any country that supplies Cuba with oil, and the U.S. Coast Guard began intercepting tankers and ships bound for the island. Power cuts in Cuba have since become very common, often lasting beyond 12 hours a day and even close to 20 hours in some provinces. Independent UN human rights experts condemned these actions, calling them “energy starvation” and an “unlawful blockade” of the island country, as the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights reported. In July 2026, the UN General Assembly voted 136-9 (with 30 abstentions) to debate the blockade despite U.S. objections. Mr. Trump, meanwhile, has threatened a takeover of the island nation – a threat that is unlawful according to the UN Charter, which prohibits “the threat or use of force” against a country’s political independence. The new blockade is over and above a 64-year-old embargo by the U.S.

Embargo or blockade?

Following the 1959 Cuban revolution, the Cuban government led by Fidel Castro nationalised U.S.-owned property in 1959-60. The U.S. responded, imposing a partial “embargo” on Cuban trade in October 1960 and making it full-fledged in 1962. Cuba terms the measures *el bloqueo*, or a blockade, as it goes beyond mere bilateral trade and is exemplified by further measures taken by the U.S. on Cuban foreign trade. The Cuban Democracy Act of 1992 barred foreign subsidiaries of U.S. firms from trading in Cuba, and the Helms-Burton Act of 1996 wrote the embargo into law, so that only the U.S. Congress can lift it. It also allowed lawsuits against foreign firms using property in Cuba that was confiscated from the Americans.

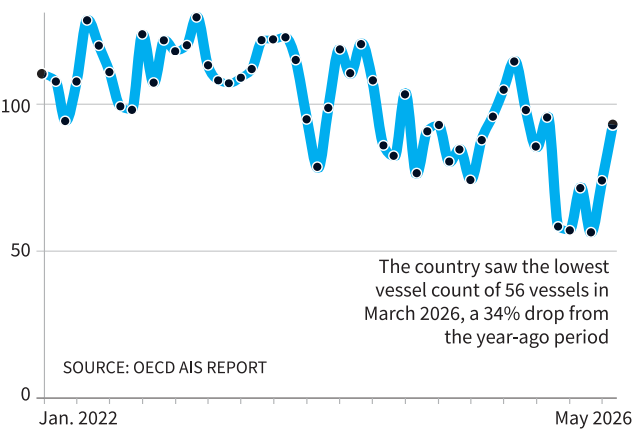
After coming to power, Mr. Trump expanded further on these punitive measures by bringing Cuba back on the State Sponsors of Terrorism list (without any justification after it was briefly removed by the outgoing Biden administration in January 2025). This has meant that banks find it difficult to deal with Cuban entities. In May, the Trump administration imposed secondary sanctions on foreign firms dealing with the Cuban state and its military conglomerate, GAESA. It has also indicted former Cuban President Raul Castro on problematic charges, besides the January 29 order, which declared a national emergency and authorised extra duties on goods from any country that sells or provides oil to Cuba.

Year after year in the UN General Assembly, since 1992, there has been near-unanimous demand to end the “embargo”, but the resolutions are not binding, and this has allowed the U.S. to continue it. Havana claims that the cumulative damage of the embargo has been to the tune of \$178.7 billion and \$8.08 billion in the year up to February 2026 itself, which includes just one month of the fuel blockade. These costs are not just lost U.S. trade, but also the impact on Cuba’s overall trade because of what the embargo imposes. For example, ships docking in Cuba are barred from

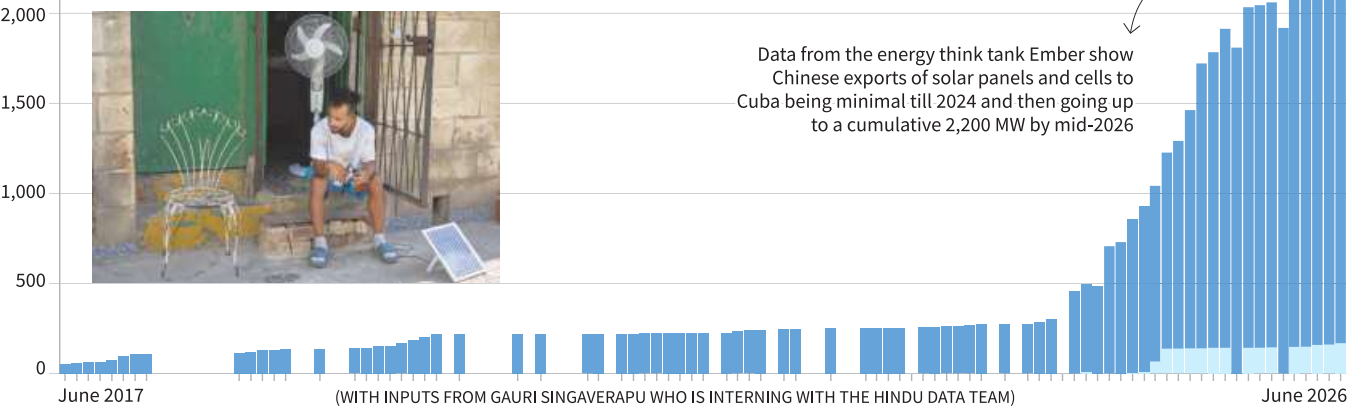
Fragile lifelines

Fewer ships and disrupted trade underline growing pressure on Cuba's economy

The chart shows the number of vessels en route to Cuba



The chart shows the export of solar panels and cells to Cuba (in capacity)



U.S. ports for 180 days, which has led to increased freight costs. With the U.S. imposing financial sanctions, banks refuse Cuban payments, and imports of medical equipment and machinery have also been affected.

Has this hostility against Cuba always been the case?

U.S. policy towards Cuba has been motivated largely by the lobbying efforts of Cuban exiles based in Miami, Florida, who fled the island following the Revolution. These hardliners include those born to Cuban-immigrant parents, such as current Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who have sought the collapse of the communist system in Cuba. They have also strongly backed the Trump administration’s actions, as making conditions that are “ripe for regime change”, according to the International Crisis Group.

The hostility against Cuba experienced a brief thaw during former President Barack Obama’s second tenure. In December 2014, he and Raul Castro announced a normalisation of ties, which led to embassies reopening, Cuba being taken off the terrorism list, and culminating in a visit to Havana by Mr Obama. Travel and remittance rules were eased, but the embargo still stayed. Mr. Trump reverted much of it during his first tenure before imposing stronger restrictions in his second tenure, which intensified after U.S. forces attacked Venezuela and abducted its president, Nicolas Maduro and took control over the Latin American country’s fuel and energy resources since then.

Why was Venezuela an important lifeline for Cuba?

Following the collapse of the Soviet Union, which affected the Cuban economy severely, leading to what was called a “special period”, Fidel Castro and Hugo Chavez signed an “oil-for-services” agreement in 2000. This led to the Barrio Adentro health missions (neighbourhood medical services) provided by Cuban

doctors in Venezuela. Some 40,000 Cuban doctors, teachers and other professionals worked in Venezuela, while the country supplied about 1,00,000 barrels of oil a day on relatively easy terms. Cuba also resold some of the oil for hard currency, according to U.S. officials, to mitigate the impact of the U.S. financial sanctions.

Meanwhile, mismanagement of the state oil company PDVSA, the 2014 crash in oil prices and later U.S. sanctions cut Venezuela’s oil output to a third by the late 2010s, leading to lowered shipments to Cuba. The imports met, by late 2025, only about a quarter of Cuban demand for oil and about a third of its oil imports.

In January 2026, that came to naught too after the U.S. took control of Venezuela’s oil sector. Mexico, which had supplied about 44% of Cuba’s oil imports, then suspended deliveries. Russia has not been able to step up and fill in the gap either, with just sporadic ships managing to deliver supplies to Cuba since the naval blockade.

What was the impact of the fuel blockade?

The International Crisis Group lists “severe disruption to transportation, food distribution, health care, water systems and communications” in the country. On May 7, three UN Special Rapporteurs said fuel scarcity was keeping people from hospitals and children from school. They cited a backlog of more than 96,000 surgeries, 11,000 of them for children, and delays in infant immunisation.

The scale of the impact is shown in satellite imagery data. An index of night-time light intensity built from NASA satellite data, a proxy for electricity use, fell from about 10-12 in 2021-25 to around six by mid-2026. Ships reaching Cuba have been reduced from 100-120 a month to just 50-60 in early 2026 and oil cargoes have become sporadic. The impact of the sanctions has also meant a large drop in employment in industries such as tourism – which the Cuban government sought to utilise to shore up its dollar reserves –

and mining and shipping. The naval blockade has also occurred at a time when one in five Cubans have emigrated in the past five years due to the weak economy.

How is China helping Cuba mitigate the fuel shortage?

On September 23, President Miguel Diaz-Canel said that Cuba has installed 1,418 MW of solar capacity in 144 parks and would pass 1,500 MW by the end of 2026. He said that renewables already generate 21.4% of the country’s electricity. Much of the equipment for these installations have arrived from China. Data from the energy think tank Ember show Chinese exports of solar panels and cells to Cuba being minimal till 2024 and then going up to a cumulative 2,200 MW by mid-2026. In September, reports showed that a third batch of 5,000 standalone solar systems donated by China arrived for public buildings and isolated homes, after shipments in August and November 2025. But power blackouts persist because solar power is not generated after sunset, when demand peaks and battery storage is inadequate in Cuba. The power grid also relies on aging oil-fired plants.

Chinese customs data also show China’s imports from Cuba rising from about \$50 million in 2015 to \$320 million in 2022, with commodities such as zinc ores, nickel products, lead and silver ores, lobsters, cigars and rum. But this trade fell to \$230 million in 2025 and \$145 million roughly in 2026 so far.

What other reforms has Havana embarked upon?

Havana approved 176 reforms in June to expand private enterprise and foreign investment, but the blockade continues to stymie these. Back-channel talks with the Trump administration have continued but there is little progress because the latter demands regime change while Havana insists that it “will not compromise on its sovereignty or political constitution”, according to ICG.

THE GIST

The U.S. has tightened pressure on Cuba through secondary sanctions, restrictions on foreign firms and a fuel blockade, building on the 64-year-old embargo that has raised trade, shipping and financial costs for Havana

Venezuela’s oil-for-services arrangement had long been a crucial lifeline for Cuba, but falling Venezuelan production, U.S. intervention and the suspension of Mexican supplies have left the island struggling to meet its fuel needs

Cuba is turning to Chinese-backed solar power and reforms to private enterprise and foreign investment to cope, but inadequate battery storage, an ageing power grid and continued sanctions have limited their impact

Why growing trust in digital payments may be leaving Indians more exposed to cybercrime

UPI has become a more trusted and frequently used mode of payment in India; but SPIR 2026 finds a paradox, people who trusted online banking the most and used UPI most often were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime; report shows how fraud networks exploit this trust through deceptive schemes, fake apps and ‘digital arrest’

Vinson Prakash

At a roadside tea stall, the QR code neatly taped on the can of biscuits now does more work than the cash box. A scan, a password, and a reassuring beep. No change to count, no note to fumble. In a country where your vegetable vendor, the auto driver and the doctor all get paid the same way, digital payments, especially UPI, have become a site where one’s bread and butter are bought and sold.

The scale is hard to overstate. UPI has processed over 24,000 crore transactions in FY 2025-26, with the transaction values crossing ₹314 lakh crore. As the world’s most populous country, India has 70% of its population connected to the internet, making it one of the most sought-after global markets for internet services and digital platforms. That vast, eager, and active user base is also a tempting target. One that is ripe to be picked on by cybercriminals. The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 shows how the two meet: how India uses the internet and how cybercriminals stay one step ahead of users.

Digital payments are a daily habit for Indians. About half (49%) of the respondents use UPI apps every day, while another quarter (24%) use them once or twice a week. UPI also stood out as the most frequently used online payment method, with almost half (48%) saying they use it “many times”, ahead of card, wallet, and NEFT/RTGS payment methods (Table 1).

Trust follows usage. UPI garnered the most trust out of all payment

The trust test

UPI dominates online payments, but the SPIR 2026 data shows that high trust and frequent use can coexist with greater exposure to cybercrime

Table 1: UPI is the most frequently used for of online payment

Online payment modes	Frequency of use		
	Many times	Sometimes	Never
UPI	48	30	19
Debit/credit card payment	20	40	33
Payment wallets	14	25	49
NEFT/RTGS	7	23	57

Note: All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond. The categories ‘never’ and ‘I don’t make online payments’ are merged to form the ‘never’ category.

Question asked: When making payments online, how frequently do you use the following a) UPI b) NEFT/RTGS c) Debit/credit card payment d) Payment wallets – many times, sometimes, or never?



Table 2: Those who consider online banking to be safe are more likely to be victims of cybercrime

Index of perceived safety of various modes of online banking	Have you been a victim of a cybercrime or helped the victim closely in cyber complaint registration/handling the issue?	
	Yes	No
Very safe	28	65
Somewhat safe	26	70
Somewhat unsafe	22	73
Very unsafe	14	80

Note: All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond.

Question asked: Have you been a victim of a cybercrime in the last 2-3 years; or did you help the victim closely in registering the cyber complaint or in handling the overall issue?

Question asked: In your opinion, how safe are these modes of online banking: a) UPI b) Mobile banking apps c) Internet banking websites d) Debit/credit card payments g) Wallet-based apps – very safe, somewhat safe, somewhat unsafe, or very unsafe?

methods, with a third (34%) of the respondents considering it “very safe” and two in five (41%) considering it “somewhat safe”, meaning three in four people consider it to be safe. Card payments came in second, with about two in three (65%) considering it safe – 28% considering it ‘very safe’ and 37% ‘somewhat safe’ – followed by wallet-based apps and mobile banking

apps. Taking all online banking modes together, a majority of the respondents find them to be safe, with about a quarter (23%) finding them “very safe” and about two in five (40%) finding them “somewhat safe”.

On its own, this is a success story. People trust a system they use constantly, and the system mostly delivers.

The trust paradox

SPIR also asked a different set of questions about behaviour, which together measure how vulnerable a person is to unsafe online practices. Would they open a link from an unverified sender? A photo, video, or file from a stranger? Share an OTP with an unknown caller? And so on.

When trust is set beside vulnerability, the pattern is striking. The people most prone to unsafe online practices were also the most confident about online banking. Among the highly vulnerable, about half (49%) called online banking modes “very safe” and another 39% considered them “somewhat safe”. Among those with moderate to no vulnerability, only about a fifth, on average, considered online banking to be “very safe”.

Following this thread towards victimisation, it was found that those who considered online banking modes as “very safe” were also more likely to have been victims of cybercrimes in the past 2-3 years. Among victims, 28% considered online banking modes to be “very safe” compared with 14% who considered online banking modes ‘very unsafe’ (Table 2). As perceptions of safety decreased, so did their likelihood of being a victim.

Usage tells the same story. Those who use UPI “many times” were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime in the last 2-3 years, compared to those who “never” use it.

People’s high trust and usage of online banking methods is being met with an adversary that is organised and inventive. A cybercrime expert in the report described a supply chain

that sells fraudsters “kits” of pre-activated SIM cards, bank accounts, and cell phones. For a small investment of ₹10,000-20,000 in these kits, the fraudsters can swindle someone’s life savings worth tens of lakhs or crores, and remain largely untraceable. The interviewed victims further shed light on the various inventive schemes cybercriminals use to defraud people. The fraudsters create entire investment/betting apps, convincingly hold victims under digital arrest for several days, and gain victims’ trust and convince them to share personal information.

The deception does not stop at victims. Two people interviewed for the report, both accused of perpetrating cybercrime, said they had lent their bank accounts to fraudsters who deceived them, leaving them part of a crime they did not fully understand. Fraudsters are not only exploiting gaps in the financial system, but they are recruiting its users and leaving them to be apprehended by the police as the most replaceable link in the chain, while they themselves go untouched.

The SPIR 2026 points to an almost paradoxical association: the more people use digital payments, the more they trust them, and the more likely they are to be victims of cybercrime. But that is only one half of the picture. The other half is a sophisticated adversary who is armed with the right tools, exploits the trust people have in their financial systems, and quite tactfully plays on the human psyche to deceive their victims.

(Vinson Prakash is a researcher at Common Cause)

Cyber fraud victims dissatisfied with banks over delayed action and poor recovery support: study

13% of respondents experienced cybercrime in the past two to three years, with 54% of victims reporting digital financial fraud; while most victims approached banks within 24 hours, many reported delays in blocking unauthorised transactions, poor support and banks’ reluctance to accept liability; victims, experts also raised several concerns

Radhika Jha

Cybercrimes have disrupted our conventional understanding of both how crimes take place and how the systems responding to them function. While there is much to be said about the non-financial cybercrimes that may be just as prevalent as financial cybercrimes, the latter have captured the public’s imagination and fears in unprecedented ways.

A recent study by Common Cause and Lokniti, CSDS, the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026: Cybercrimes – Victim Perspectives and Systemic Responses, brings out the perspectives of the common public, victims, and domain experts on this issue, focusing on how victims navigate through the complex systems. The study is based on a survey of 8,306 respondents from across 16 States/U.T.s, along with in-depth interviews with 37 stakeholders, including victims, cybercrime experts, and others.

In financial cybercrime cases, the banking sector becomes an integral part of the reporting and resolution process, widening the traditional understanding of the core criminal justice institutions such as the police and courts. In this context, the study explores, among other things, whether banks as an institution are prepared to deal with these cases and to take accountability for security lapses.

According to the survey data, 13% of the overall respondents were victims of cybercrimes in the last 2-3 years. Among the victims, more than half (54%) were victims of digital financial frauds.

One of the first actions taken by the victim after the incident was complaining directly to the banks. More than half of the victims of digital financial fraud (52%) who were surveyed said that they had complained to the bank separately after the incident. A majority, 63%, complained within the first 24 hours.

Banks’ response

Despite the promptness in reporting shown by many victims, the response by the banks leaves much to be

Banking on banks

Table 1: More than half of all cybercrimes involve digital financial frauds

Nature of crime	Victims
Digital financial frauds	54
Hacking of devices	13
Personal data theft	11
Cyberbullying/abuse on social media	7
Online sexual harassment	4

Note: The rest did not respond or reported facing other types of crime. All figures are in percentages

Question: What type of crime did you face?

Table 2: Nearly two out of three respondents reported the fraud to the bank within 24 hours

Time taken to report the fraud after it occurred	Victims/respondents who assisted victims of cybercrimes (%)
Within 24 hours	63
Within 48 hours	21
More than 48 hours	11

Note: The rest did not respond.

Question asked: How soon after the fraud did you/they report it- within 24 hours, within 48 hours, more than 48 hours?

desired. A 2017 RBI guideline states that in cases of third-party breach due to no deficiency by either the bank or the customer, and if the customer notifies the bank within three days, the loss must be borne by the bank entirely. This was extended on a pilot basis in 2026 to include those cases wherein the customer had been tricked or coerced into making scam payments, with limited liability being placed on the bank in such cases.

In-depth interviews with victims revealed, however, that the banks’ response to cybercrimes is almost entirely focused on evading accountability and liability. The standard response from the banks in cases of digital financial fraud is that the victim “collaborated” with the perpetrator of the cybercrime. All the victims of digital financial cybercrimes who were interviewed qualitatively, barring one, said that the bank maintained this in their case, even in cases where the victims did not interact with the perpetrators at any point. Notably, the one case in which the banks did not give this response included a high net-worth individual

Victims often report fraud quickly, but face delays and poor support when seeking recovery

Table 3: Two-fifths of the victims who complained separately to the bank feel that crime occurred due to a breach of personal data

Complained made separately to the bank (among victim)	Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data	No, it didn’t happen because of the breach of personal data
Yes	40	44
No	26	54

Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages.

Question asked: Some victims of financial cybercrimes believe that their financial data was leaked by a bank insider because of which they were targeted by criminals. In your case, do you think the crime occurred due to a breach of your personal data by the bank or its personnel?

Statement 1: Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data; Statement 2: No, it didn’t happen because of that.

Table 4: Nearly a quarter of the victims of cyber fraud are very dissatisfied with the bank’s role in recovery of money

	Degree of satisfaction			
	Very satisfied	Somewhat satisfied	Somewhat dissatisfied	Very dissatisfied
The bank’s role in recovering the money	11	21	16	22

Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages. The table includes responses from both the victims and those who assisted cybercrime victims of digital financial fraud.

Question asked: How satisfied were you with the following – very satisfied, somewhat satisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, or very dissatisfied?

with a long-standing relationship with the bank.

Low satisfaction

Vipin (name changed), a Gurgaon-based journalist, got a scam call for SIM upgradation on a Saturday. The caller, pretending to be an Airtel employee, shared some of his personal information to appear legitimate, including his name, date of birth, Aadhaar number, and debit card number. Despite cutting the call, ₹5,000 was withdrawn from a payment wallet linked to his number the following day. He immediately blocked his number and emailed his bank, since it was closed on Sunday. However, by Monday afternoon, his account had still not been blocked, and the fraudsters had taken a loan of ₹5 lakhs against his credit card, half of which had already been withdrawn. The bank, however, took “zero accountability” for this loss and was “apathetic” to the complaint, as reported by him.

Other victims reported similar instances of delays by the banks in stopping the flow of unauthorised

transactions immediately following the complaint. While the banks become directly liable for such losses when presented with such evidence of negligence in taking prompt action, there is little accountability for the mental, physical and financial costs to the victim in the recovery process necessitated by such negligence

Data (in)security

A more serious allegation levelled against the banks, both by cybercrime experts as well as victims, is that of complicity in the cybercrimes, whether directly or indirectly. The survey data shows that amongst victims who complained to the bank separately, as many as 40% were of the opinion that the cybercrime occurred due to their financial data being leaked by a bank insider. Amongst those who did not complain to the bank separately, 26% hold this opinion. Overall, while a significant proportion of the victims feel that the breach of their personal data enabled the cybercrime incident, this sentiment is amplified amongst those who had first-hand experience with the bank in

dealing with their case.

In-depth interviews with victims made similar grave allegations against the banks. Of the 13 digital financial fraud victims interviewed, five victims were of the opinion that bank officials were directly or indirectly complicit in the crime. One of the victims was told by the police officer investigating her case that the bank must be complicit, though no charges were filed against it.

Cybercrime experts and senior police officers dealing with these cases strongly supported this perception. They further stressed the lack of accountability for the common leakages of customer data, due to inadequate security systems.

Another major systemic loophole is the lack of due diligence by banks when opening bank accounts, which can be used as mule accounts in cybercrime cases. Policing and cybercrime experts were of the opinion that banks prioritise their business interests over building secure systems. “People like you and me will lose access to our accounts due to KYC procedures, but these accounts [the cyber criminals’] will never be closed”, stated a former police officer.

Satisfaction with the banks

Overall, the levels of satisfaction with the banks remained low across the victims of digital financial cybercrimes, as is emerging both from the survey data as well as the in-depth interviews with victims. More than one out of five victims of digital financial fraud surveyed reported being “very dissatisfied” with the bank’s role in recovering money, while 16% said that they were somewhat dissatisfied.

Amongst the in-depth interview respondents, the satisfaction levels were lower, with the victims rating the banks a poor one out of five. Even in cases where the victims were able to recover their money fully or partially, the satisfaction with the banks remained low. Notably, there was not much variation in the reported experience or satisfaction levels across private and public-sector banks. (Radhika Jha is Project Lead (Rule of Law) at Common Cause and lead researcher and author of the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) series. Views expressed are personal)



Rally call: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others during the march in Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA



In ground zero: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge joins the march demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. ANI



Standing together: Opposition MPs Mahua Moitra, Supriya Sule and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra raising slogans. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA



Forcibly removed: Congress MP K.C. Venugopal being detained by police personnel after the sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan. PTI

Daylong protest: Rahul dominates airwaves from Akashvani Bhavan

After police appeared to have broken up the Opposition's march against the ECI, the Leader of the Opposition improvised by turning the campus of the broadcasting house into the unlikely centre of an all-day sit-in that lasted well past sunset

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

It looked as though the protests were winding down around noon on Tuesday, as buses packed with protesting MPs trundled away from Akashvani Bhavan in the national capital after nearly two hours of sloganeering.

Only Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi had another idea. “This can’t end here,” Mr. Gandhi told his colleagues. “Where is Priyanka [Gandhi]? Where is Akhilesh [Yadav]?” he asked. Both leaders had been packed into buses by the police.

Many Congress MPs, along with Ms. Gandhi, got down from the buses they had been packed into. But the bus carrying Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, which also had Trinamool Congress’s Abhishek Banerjee, CPI(M)’s John Brittas and others, had already left the site.

Mr. Gandhi first proposed that the remaining group march to India Gate and tried walking back towards Parliament, away from the barricades, only



Locked in: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and others during the sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

to be told that all roads were blocked. So, he turned back.

Squeezed into premises
In front of Akashvani Bhavan, he spotted staffers who had spent two hours standing on the parapet wall and watching the protest unfold. Mr. Gandhi waved at them and then, without any warning, waded into the crowd and headed for the narrow

pedestrian gate of the complex. He squeezed his way into the premises.

A few Congress MPs managed to follow. Others, including senior leaders K.C. Venugopal and Pawan Khera, were initially stopped at the gate and stood at the grills before the Delhi Police, after some discussion, allowed them to join Mr. Gandhi.

Around 2.30 p.m., a large group of Indian

Youth Congress (IYC) and National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) activists descended on Akashvani Bhavan. Catching the heavily deployed police personnel by surprise, the activists charged at the iron gates, with many managing to run into the campus. The police reacted swiftly, slamming the gates shut, this time with the activists inside. Buses soon arrived to detain them.

One young activist clambered onto the roof of a police bus and waved an NSUI flag. He was later pulled down by a Delhi Police officer. The buses eventually cleared the premises of the activists.

Meanwhile, Mr. Gandhi and a small group of Congress leaders continued their sit-in under a banyan tree.

By evening, with Mr. Gandhi and the Congress leadership refusing to budge, more leaders joined in. Trinamool Congress leaders Derek O’Brien and Mahua Moitra, who had been bundled away by the police earlier, returned to the site.

Around 8 p.m., the Delhi Police finally moved to clear the campus. Officers first removed the leaders gathered around Mr. Gandhi one by one. Finally, Mr. Gandhi himself was dragged towards a mini-bus. He resisted throughout, at one point even attempting to wriggle out through a window.

In videos later shared by the Congress, leaders detained at the Kingsway Camp police station could be seen raising slogans.

Opposition MPs’ demand for meeting at Parliament Annexe ‘unusual’, says ECI

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

As the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), led by Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, sat on a more than eight-hour dharna on Tuesday, the Election Commission of India (ECI) said that the Opposition parties had demanded a meeting with the full Commission at a venue outside the ECI premises, which was “unusual” and therefore “could not be accepted”.

The ECI said it had offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to the proposed meeting venue to receive the memorandum of the protesting MPs, which in itself would have been an “unprecedented” step. However, this offer was also declined by the protesting leaders.

‘Learnt through media’
In an official statement issued after Mr. Gandhi was detained from his protest site inside Akashvani Bhavan, the headquarters of All India Radio in the national capital, the poll body said it had learnt through the media till 4



Till 4.00 p.m. today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission

ECI STATEMENT

p.m. that some MPs wished to meet the Commission along with their delegation during a march by certain political parties towards the ECI.

“With regard to today’s developments, it is clarified that, till 4.00 p.m. today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission,” it said.

However, at around 4.00 p.m., information was received from the Delhi Police that a delegation of MPs, led by Mr. Gandhi, wished to meet the Commission and submit a memorandum.

Following this, when the Election Commission was considering the request, it was informed by the Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP), Delhi Pol-

ice, that the delegation comprised 240 MPs and that the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annexe.

ECI protocol
“The Election Commission considered this request as unusual and therefore, could not be accepted, as, in accordance with ECI protocol, such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India,” the statement said.

The ECI said it instead offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to receive the memorandum, but the offer was rejected by the Opposition MPs.

The statement further said that in 2025, the ECI had laid down a procedure for meetings with political parties. All political parties had been informed of the same.

Under the procedure, whenever a delegation of a political party or a joint delegation of several parties wishes to meet the Commission, it seeks an appointment through its duly authorised representative. The meeting is thereafter held at a time mutually agreed upon, the poll body said.

Rahul’s protest is a ‘political drama’, claims made by Congress are lies: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Describing the Congress-led protests against the special intensive revision (SIR) as a “political drama” staged by the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Tuesday accused him and the Congress of “lying” to mislead the people.

The Election Commission of India’s (ECI) formal statement on the issue exposed their claims, it said.

At a late-evening press conference, BJP MP and spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi cited the ECI statement to assert that the poll panel did not receive any request from either the Congress party or any other constituent of the INDIA bloc for a meeting.

‘No genuine intention’
He alleged that the sequence of events demonstrated that the Congress leaders had no genuine intention to meet the Commission, but only to create

a “political spectacle”.

Questioning the claim about the number of MPs at the protest, Mr. Trivedi said the Congress had 99 MPs in the Lok Sabha and 30 in the Rajya Sabha, and the Samajwadi Party had 37 MPs, who, he said, were not at the protest site in the evening. He said the Trinamool MPs were also absent, while the DMK and the Aam Aadmi Party stayed away.

“It is very clear that the entire exercise was carried out to turn democracy into

a monarchy, while wearing the mask of democracy, and to establish that very monarchy,” said Mr. Trivedi.

The BJP leader said the sit-in by Mr. Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and their party colleagues at Akashvani Bhavan reflected the “same mindset of the Congress that does not accept democracy”.

Mr. Trivedi questioned at whose behest the Congress “continued to level allegations despite being repeatedly proven wrong”.

Left off poll rolls, 4 West Bengal men detained for a month in Chhattisgarh

Senjuti Sengupta
MURSHIDABAD

The Chhattisgarh Police have detained four migrant workers from Murshidabad, West Bengal over suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals, after their names were deleted from the voters’ list during the recent special intensive revision (SIR) exercise.

They have been lodged at a detention centre in Raipur for over a month despite reportedly being long-time Indian residents.

Late in August, at least 23 migrant workers, including the four persons Sabir Sheikh (42), Safikul Islam (39), Nasiruddin Sheikh (35), and Laltu Sheikh (28) from Samser-



Family members of the four migrant workers who have been lodged at the Chhattisgarh detention centre. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ganj and Sahabad areas of Murshidabad, went to Chhattisgarh in search of work. On September 4, the Chhattisgarh Police detained 23 persons from their residences in Chunchiapara-Ganesh Nagar on suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals. They were taken to a holding centre in

Raipur for illegal immigrants.

Nineteen of them were released on September 18 after a local court passed an order while these four men continued to be lodged at the detention centre. The police, in court, questioned their nationality based on the dele-

tion of their names in the SIR exercise. Interestingly, the rest of the 19 persons found their names back on the voters list after the adjudication process.

“I have been staying in Samserganj since my childhood. Our old house was a century old, as my great-grandfather had probably built it. After it was washed away due to soil erosion, we set up our new residence in 1973. How could my son be a Bangladeshi?” said Safikul’s father, the 67-year-old Riyajul Sheikh.

They have appealed before the tribunal seeking restoration of their names.

The family members have also filed a petition in the Calcutta High Court seeking their release.

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1170.00 Lakh

निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, अर्जित राशि, कानूनीय कर्तव्य व शर्तों की सही सही समझूँ विवरण एवं संबंधित वेबसाइट: <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://www.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।
इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने निविदा हस्ताक्षर के साथमें से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।
महानिदेशक

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED
e - TENDER NOTICE

The TGTransco invites online Bids under e-procurement for supply of the following Equipment's: 1. **Tender Specification No.TGPM11-38/26**, Description of Equipment: 33kV CTs (2000-1000-600/1-1-1)A. 2. **Tender Specification No. TGPM25-35/2026**, Description of Equipment: Supply of 50MVA 220/33kV Power Transformers.
Bidders/Tenderers can have further details and download the tender schedule from e-procurement market place i.e., www.tender.telangana.gov.in. Contact Nos.: CE/P&MM, Phone: 040-23396000 (Extn.: 3670/3583/3460/3521/3334/3276/3522), Fax No. 040-2330376, www.tgtransco.com
DIPR No. 624-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27

Sd/- Chief Engineer/P&MM

OFFICE OF THE PRINCIPAL & CONTROLLER
RUHS COLLEGE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES,
Sector – 11, Kumbhna Marg, Pratap Nagar, Jaipur - 302033
Ph.: 0141-2795626, 634 Email: prncipl@ruhsj.org

No. :- F. () RUHS CMS/Store/2026-27/8159 Date : 01/10/2026

Notice Inviting E-Bids
राज. स्वा. वि. वि. आर्यविज्ञान महाविद्यालय में NICU/PICU/ICU के लिए कार्य की प्रकृति के आधार पर उच्च कुशल एवं अर्द्धकुशल मेनपावर (नर्स ग्रेड-II एवं वार्ड अटेंडेंट्स) सेवाओं के उपापन हेतु दर सविदा हेतु (कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 2,00,000,00/-) दिनांक 22/10/2026 को अपरान्ह 02.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। अधिक विवरण के लिए वेबसाइट Website sppp.rajinic.in or eprocrajasthan.gov.in का अवलोकन करें।
UBN: CMS2627WLB00062
Raj Samwad/C/26/11337

Principal

Office Of Superintending Engineer
PHED Circle Jhalawar (Rajasthan)
NOTICE INVITING Bid No. 23/2026-27 Item No. 1-A to 1-C
Bids for Annual Rate contract for Construction & commissioning of 200 mm dia tube wells with submersible pump sets etc. complete work in all types of strata & laying, jointing, testing, commissioning of HDPE pipe line including defect liability period of PANCHAYAT SAMITI AKLERA, MANOHARTANA, JHALARAPATAN, KHANPUR, BAKANI, BHAWANI MANDI, DAG & PIRAEA of PHED Division Jhalawar/ Bhawani Mandi, District Jhalawar (With Material Complete) are invited from interested bidders upto 15.10.2025 at 18.00 Hours. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the [www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in](http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in), <http://rajwater.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>. Departmental websites.
NIB No. PHE2627A2840
UBN No. PHE2627WSRC06010, PHE2627WSRC06011, PHE2627WSRC06013
Superintending Engineer
PHED Circle Jhalawar
DIPRC/17083/2026

Andhra Pradesh Drones Corporation Pvt. Ltd.
(An Enterprise of the Government of Andhra Pradesh)
3rd Floor, NTR Administrative Block, Pandit Nehru Bus Station, NH-65, Vijayawada-520013, Andhra Pradesh.
Notice No: APDC/RFP/02/2026, Dt. 07-10-2026

Andhra Pradesh Drones Corporation Pvt Ltd (APDC) invites tenders through two-bid system from Potential Drone Manufacturers / OEMs for Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Training and Post-Supply Support of Geospatial Survey and Mapping Drone Systems in Andhra Pradesh. Interested firms are requested to submit their bid proposals. The RFP document & other details can be downloaded from the website (<https://apdrones.ap.gov.in/#/home/tenders>) & bids can be submitted through the e-Procurement Platform of the Government of Andhra Pradesh (<https://tender.aperecurement.gov.in>).
DIPR 5481PP/CL, Dt.06-10-2026
Managing Director

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmsh.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- F02 (459)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-21/2026-27/5192 A Dated :- 28/09/2026

NOTICE INVITING E-Bids
e-Bids are invited by RMSCL, Jaipur from bonafide MANUFACTURERS / LOAN LICENSEE / IMPORTERS / CO- MARKETERS with sole marketing rights for imported proprietary items for rate contract cum supply and empanelment of bidders for Drugs & Medicines. The last date of submission of duly filled up form along with documents on e-proc i.e. <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and submission of fees is upto 06.00 PM of 27.10.2026 Details of NIB may be seen at the website of State Public Procurement Portal <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>, <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://rmsh.health.rajasthan.gov.in> and may be downloaded from there.
Estimated Value (Rs.): - 132.17 Crore
UBN No. - MSC2627GLOB00061
Raj Samwad/C/26/11364

Director (Proc.)
RMSCL, Jaipur

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Enterprises)
CIN : U85110KA1970SGC001919

No.KPCL/2026-27/PIN/WORK INDENT4878 Date: 03.10.2026

ABSTRACT BID NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP Portal only) (Two Cover System)
KPCL invites bids through GoK KPP Portal Platform <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from the qualified bidders for the following scope of work.
"Design, Engineering, Manufacture, quality surveillance, inspection & testing at manufacturer's works, supply, packing, forwarding, transportation to site, unloading storage, preservation, handling, insurance, dismantling of existing Platen Super Heater (PLSH), Re-heater (RH) & Final Super Heater (FSH) coil assemblies, erection, testing and commissioning of new PLSH, RH & FSH coil assemblies along with connected accessories, including hydraulic testing & steam blowing, for the 210 MW Unit-1 Boiler at Raichur Thermal Power Station of KPCL". Last Date and Time for submission Tender : 03.11.2026 at 17:00 hours.
Further details can be had form: **Chief Engineer (Thermal Designs)**, KPCL, No.3, 2nd Floor, Green Building, (Drug Controller Office Premises), Palace Road, Bengaluru-560 001. **Mobile: 9480682537, E-mail: kpclcetd@gmail.com, cetdkpcl@gmail.com, cetdeerm@gmail.com Website: <https://kpcl.karnataka.gov.in>**

NEW DELHI
Twelve crew members injured
after tanker attacked off Oman



REUTERS

Twelve crew members on a Panama-flagged tanker were injured in an attack while crossing the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said in a statement, with those injured receiving medical treatment in Oman. The Ministry said the tanker, *MT On Peace*, had a 19-member crew, including 17 Indians. AFP

BERLIN
Germany arrests ex-spy chief for
‘passing secrets to foreign powers’



AP

A former German spy chief was arrested on Tuesday on suspicion of passing sensitive information to foreign powers. August Hanning, who ran Germany's BND foreign intelligence agency from 1998 to 2005, is accused of espionage, treason and working for foreign intelligence services, federal prosecutors said. AFP

PARIS
Hundreds held in France as school
protests descend into violence



REUTERS

Mass protests over decrepit conditions at France's high schools descended into sporadic violence on Tuesday, leading to nearly 500 arrests and prompting President Emmanuel Macron to call a meeting. The Interior Ministry said 256,000 people protested nationwide, while union organisers put the figure at 450,000. AFP

NAIROBI
Kenya confirms first Ebola case
after traveller from Congo dies



REUTERS

Kenyan authorities on Tuesday confirmed the country's first imported Ebola case from Congo, making Kenya the latest country affected by the fast-moving outbreak. Health Minister Aden Duale said a Kenyan citizen who arrived from Congo via Uganda tested positive for the Ebola virus and died late Monday. AP

Ukraine fires
900 drones
overnight
at Russia

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday. Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. Ukrainian officials are now bracing for what President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned is an upcoming “massive” aerial attack by Russia. “Today, we received updated intelligence on Russia's preparations for a massive strike. We are preparing countermeasures,” Mr. Zelenskyy said. Meanwhile, the Russian Defence Ministry said its forces overnight struck targets in Ukraine's southern Odesa region on the Black Sea coast with drones, where an ammunition depot was hit.

Houthis ‘hit’ Riyadh airport;
Yemen military claims gains

The group denies being pushed back and says it still controlled territory seized during its recent advance along Yemen's Red Sea coast; Riyadh airport is facing temporary closures of its airspace

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) claimed an attack on the Saudi capital's main airport and on Tuesday denied being pushed back by government forces, who have launched a major operation to recapture lost territory. The Houthi statements come as Yemen's military said it had removed the pro-Iran group from areas around the Bab el-Mandeb strait, a Red Sea choke-point, and the port city of Mokha. Claims by both sides in Yemen have been impossible to independently verify, with the situation on the ground moving fast and access for journalists difficult. Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said the group still held all territory seized last month when they swept through



Pro-government fighters celebrate while riding vehicles in a convoy near the Bab el-Mandeb Strait in Taiz on Tuesday. AFP

coastal areas along the Red Sea oil-and-cargo route. Houthi fighters “have full control over all their advances on the ground”, he posted on Telegram. Mr. Saree said they had carried out dozens of strikes in the past few hours targeting government forces in Yemen's Al-Jawf and Marib regions, while also attacking Taiz governorate. On Monday, the Houthis said they had struck Ri-

yadh airport and a refinery belonging to Saudi state oil giant Aramco. Loud explosions rattled the Saudi capital on Monday evening. They were followed by another explosion on Tuesday that echoed through northern parts of the city, residents said. Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport is facing frequent temporary closures of its airspace, according to tracking website Flightradar24. Saudi authorities have not publicly acknowledged the closures or confirmed any strikes targeting the facility. But on Tuesday the civil aviation authority said at least three people were wounded in attacks on Jazan and Najran airports near the Yemen border a day earlier. Saudi Arabia, the main backer of the Yemeni government, has been providing air support for the counter-offensive launched by government forces. Government forces claimed late Monday that they had achieved “victories on several fronts”. But military sources with the government refrained from confirming Mokha's recapture, only saying they had cut the one supply route to the area. They also said they expelled the Houthis from several areas in Taiz in the southwest.

Jeffrey Archer, bestselling
British novelist, dies at 86

Associated Press
LONDON

Bestselling British author Jeffrey Archer, whose career as a politician was derailed by a perjury conviction, has died. He was 86. Archer died “suddenly and peacefully” at his home on Monday, a day before the global release of his final novel, *Adam and Eve*, publisher HarperCollins said. Like his bestseller *Kane and Abel*, the new book follows a pair of biblically named characters born on the same day to different social classes. Both a celebrated author and scandal-plagued politician, Archer's professional life teetered between triumph and turmoil as he wrote his way through a brief prison sentence and returned to the political arena. His writing career spanned five decades and helped him bounce back from financial ruin following some bad investments. His debut novel, *Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less*, hit the shelves in 1976 and was said to have been in-



Jeffrey Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher. NAGARA GOPAL

spired by his own experience nearly going bankrupt. He went on to spend 14 years and five months on Britain's *Sunday Times* bestseller lists and over five years on *The New York Times* bestseller lists, selling 300 million books worldwide, according to HarperCollins. **Political stint** Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher and was appointed in 1992 to the House of Lords by her successor, Prime Minister John Major. Archer was cast out of his political party just before he was jailed on perjury charges in 2001. Archer chronicled his time behind bars in a three-volume series titled *A Prison Diary*. The memoirs – *Hell, Purgatory and Heaven* – shared rare insight into the lives of inmates in British prisons, from the high-security HMP Belmarsh to the North Sea Camp open prison. Archer is survived by his wife of 60 years, Dame Mary Archer, their two sons, two granddaughters and three grandsons, his publisher said.

Why NASA wants to build a
nuclear reactor on the moon

NEWS ANALYSIS

Vasudevan Mukunth



View of Moon limb. ISTOCKPHOTO

NASA wants to install a nuclear reactor near the moon's south pole by 2030. Its planned output, 20 kilowatt (kW), could power a few households on earth. Russia's planned reactor for the International Lunar Research Station (ILRS), led by China, will produce around 10 kW. But the fact that they are nuclear makes them significant. The U.S. and China are pursuing parallel efforts today – in partnership with other countries – to be the first to set up a semi-permanent, and in future permanent, moon base. Such a facility will need electricity for everything from heating and life-support to recharging rover batteries. European scientists are also exploring lunar microreactors. At most locations on the moon, a fortnight of daylight follows a fortnight of darkness. Near the south pole, where both factions are focusing their activities, promontories and craters create a pastiche of lit and shadowed patches, with temperatures inside some of the latter dipping under a frigid -200 C. But unlike solar panels, a nuclear reactor can produce power even in the dark. The colder craters preserve water ice, which can quench astronauts' thirst and can also be electro-

lysed to produce hydrogen and oxygen, to power rockets launched from the moon itself. In one 2020 assessment, NASA scientists Julie Kleinhenz and Aaron Paz figured producing 10 tonnes of oxygen this way would require around 68 kW of power. So a 20-kW reactor could be a stepping stone in countries' plans to set up an array of reactors on the moon. While the moon as a whole is barren, the more ideal locations, with longer periods of sunlight, terrain more suitable to land on, access to craters with water ice, and so on, are highly limited. Research commissioned by NASA has recommended situating nuclear reactors at least 1 km away from humans. Now, the Outer Space Treaty 1967 says no country may appropriate any part of the moon through occupation or other means. But the Artemis Accords, to which the U.S. and its allies vis-à-vis the moon are signatories, envisage 'safety zones' to prevent harmful interference. Put differently, a state does not have to stake territory

on the moon to limit access to others: it can simply plonk a nuclear reactor there and appeal to the need for legitimate safety requirements. The Accords say these zones must be temporary and respect free access – but a country or a bloc operating a cluster of reactors, landing pads, mines, and habitats could nevertheless gain a controlling advantage. For the appeal of this idea, however, both Artemis and ILRS face breathtaking technical hurdles. Shielding a nuclear reactor on the moon demands either launching the components to ensure its safe operation or producing them on the moon with lunar resources. Distanting a reactor from a base demands deployment machines and power cables. The reactor core will also have to be launched unirradiated and, once online, space agencies will have to find ways to absorb and store all the heat – or radiate waste heat away from large surfaces kept free of moon dust. If a reactor fails on the moon, it could contaminate the same few places astronauts would like to be at. While nuclear power could prove indispensable to a mature economy centred on the moon, no country possesses that economy today even as governments are being tempted to install reactors before their opponents – a danger in itself.

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmssc.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2015SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in
Ref. No. :- E-02 (454)/RMSC/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-16/2026-27/5191 Dated :- 28/09/2026
NOTICE INVITING E-Bids
e-Bids are invited by RMSC, Jaipur from bonafide MANUFACTURERS / LOAN LICENSEE / IMPORTERS / CO-MARKETERS with sole marketing rights for imported proprietary items for rate contract cum supply and empanelment of bidders for Drugs & Medicines. The last date of submission of duly filled up form along with documents on e-proc i.e. <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and submission of fees is upto 06.00 PM of 27.10.2026 Details of NIB may be seen at the website of State Public Procurement Portal. <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>, <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in.>, <http://rmssc.health.rajasthan.gov.in> and may be downloaded from there.
Estimated Value (Rs.): - 278.77 Crore
UBN No. MSC2627GLOB00055
Raj.Samwad/CJ/26/11359
Director (Proc.)
RMSC, Jaipur

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN:U40109KA1999SGC025521)
No.CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2026-27/7165-80 Date: 05.10.2026
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)
KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Total Turnkey Basis**.

Sl.No.	Enquiry number and Name of the Works
1.	KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4259 Running of 220kV, 1200 sqmm UG Cable as an alternate source for 220/66/11kV Koramangala GIS sub-station from 220/66/11kV HSR Layout sub-station for a route length of 6.87km along with construction of 220kV terminal bays at both ends in Bengaluru South Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.
2.	KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4258(Short-term tender) Running of 66kV, 630 sqmm UG Cable from location No.43 to 54 in Cheelandavadi village state forest Cauvery wildlife protected area for a distance of 1.265 kms , as a part of the work of Construction of proposed 66kV SC Line on DC towers from existing 66/11 kV Doddalahalli S/S to proposed 66/11kV Hegganur sub-station in Kanakapura Taluk, Bengaluru South District.

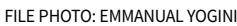
The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after **09.10.2026 @ 15:00 hrs.** Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP Portal. Any other details required in this regard can also be had from the Office of the undersigned during Office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.
Sd/- Chief Engineer(Electy.),
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavan, A.R Circle, Bengaluru-560009.

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଡ଼
(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007
ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

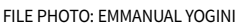
E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
EIC- BharatNet -e- Tender- 3/2026-27	Supply and erection of 120 Nos 8/9 metre PSC Poles and stringing of OverHead ADSS Fibre (65Km) in Bharatnet phase-II network in Odisha. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 20.10.2026 upto 12:30 PM.	Rs. 45,67,190/-
CPC- 68/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection and commissioning of Strengthening of Existing Overhead Lines within 60kms of Coastal belt Districts in priority towards mitigation projects for construction of Disaster Resilient Power Infrastructure from SDMF on Turnkey Contract basis in e-tendering mode only. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 04.11.2026 upto 11:00 Hrs.	Rs. 1,15,64,95,241/-
CPC- 71/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and commissioning of (I) 765/400/220kV GIS Sub-Station at Khuntuni (At Betakholi) with 3x1500MVA, 765/400kV ICT, 2x240MVAR, 765kV Bus reactor, 3 x 500MVA, 400/220kV ICT and 1x125MVAR, 400kV Bus reactor (ii) 765 kV DC LINE HEXA ACSR ZEBRA from existing 765/400 kV AIS Grid S/S, PGCIL, Phulapada (Angul) - To proposed 765/400/220kV GIS S/S, Betakholi (74.059 kms) (iii) 400 kV Quad MOOSE LINE from Betakholi to Mendhasal on Multi Circuit Towers (31.92 kms) and one no. dia extension at 400/220/132 kV Grid S/S, Mendhasal for connectivity of 400kV Betakholi-Mendhasal Transmission Line on EPC Contract basis in e- tendering mode only. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:45 PM.	Rs. 16,76,95,79,953/-
CPC- 76/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Procurement of Structure Materials & HDG Nut & bolts for Balance work of two nos. 132kV feeder bay extension each at 220/132/33kV Grid Sub-Station, Jaypatna and 132/33 kV Grid Sub-Station Junagarh and 132kV DC line from existing 220/132/33kV Grid Substation, Jaipatna (Baner) to LILO point (Loc no. 41/1).	Rs. 5,50,22,814/-
CPC- 77/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Carrying out Forest clearance work of an area of approx. 90Ha of land proposed for construction of 400kV Quad Moose DC Line from Jeypore GSS(PGCIL) to Theruvali GSS.	Rs. 1,35,48,005/-

Complete set of bidding documents are available at www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL and www.optcl.co.in.
©/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha HIPR-64/2026-27

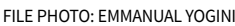
You gave Indian cricket everything as captain, Harman: Yuvraj



‘Since the day I made my debut,
you’ve always been there for me’



BCCI invites applications for Agarkar's replacement



Abhishek, Gill, Shree Charani and Shafali the ICC PoTM nominees



Tap in: Sanabria, foreground, slots home Uruguay's fifth goal. K.R. DEEPAK

India's fight fades as Uruguay nets six

Harmanpreet quits captaincy, Smriti named new skipper

Harmanpreet gets the timing right in leaving leadership role

The dates: Oct. 23, 25 and 28.
All matches at Vadodara. Start
time 2 p.m.

INBRIEF



Djokovic triumphs as de Minaur retires injured

Novak Djokovic won his seventh China Open title after Alex de Minaur retired with a groin injury during the final in Beijing on Tuesday. de Minaur left the court for a medical timeout after losing the first-set tie-breaker, but played on with his left thigh bandaged. However, he had to stop after winning the first game of the second set, leaving him trailing 6-7(3), 1-0. Sixth-ranked Djokovic's win continued his unbeaten record at the tournament with 34 straight victories.

IOC confirms India's interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics

India, Qatar and South Africa were confirmed on Tuesday among the seven countries interested in hosting the 2036 Summer Olympics. Germany, Hungary, Turkiye and South Korea make up the rest of the current list issued by the International Olympic Committee (IOC). Other countries have until October 31 to declare an interest. In March 2027, the IOC Executive Board will draw up a shortlist of the interested parties, who will then enter dialogue with the Olympic body. India is most likely to host it in Ahmedabad, the venue for the 2030 Commonwealth Games.

McSweeney, Sutherland and Beardman do the star turn as Australia-A goes one up

AUS-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

Four wickets against his name, three with balls over 142 kmph on the speed gun. Mahli Beardman's ragging balls of fire proved too hot for India-A as it succumbed to a 125-run loss to Australia-A in the first one-dayer at the CAP Ground here on Tuesday.

The 21-year-old's timely strikes helped bowl the home side out for 149 after

Nathan McSweeney scored a fighting hundred (123, 135b, 13x4) to post a target of 275. Rajat Patidar was the only Indian batter (53, 51b, 5x4, 1x6) to put up some resistance.

After choosing to bat, Australia-A was pushed on to the back foot quickly. Yash Thakur used the short ball to force Mitch Owen and Sam Konstas into mistimed pulls.

With two more edges finding the fielders, the visitor found themselves in trouble at 87 for five. But McSweeney and captain

Will Sutherland (77, 68b, 2x4, 4x6) arrested the slide with a sixth-wicket partnership of 141.

Upping the ante

Sutherland shifted gears as the lights came on for the final hour of the innings. He used his long levers to loft spinners into the leg-side fence. Just as Australia-A's fightback looked set to help it reach 300, Suryansh Shedge (four for 40) picked three in four overs to close out the innings.

Despite Beardman sending the Indian top-order

packing by beating them with his pace, India-A continued to harbour hopes of chasing the total down with its extended batting line-up.

Patidar managed to forge steady partnerships with skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad (15) and Nishant Sindhu (31). But once they fell, the lower-order folded up.

The scores: Australia-A 274 in 48.2 overs (Nathan McSweeney 123, Will Sutherland 77, Thakur 3/47, Shedge 4/40) bt India-A 149 in 31.4 overs (Rajat Patidar 53, Beardman 4/23). **Toss:** Australia-A; **PoM:** McSweeney.

France roars back to rout Belgium; Italy beats Turkiye



Influential: Olise's scruffed shot trickles past the Belgian defence for France's third. AFP

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Michael Olise starred as France stormed back from behind to thrash Belgium 4-1 in the UEFA Nations League on Monday, while Italy continued its resurgence with victory over Turkiye.

Dodi Lukebakio's first-half strike had Belgium on track for a first competitive victory over France since 1981, but Zinedine Zidane turned to his star-studded bench and the host produced a devastating late surge.

Les Bleus struck four times in the final 13 minutes to keep Zidane's unbeaten record as coach intact as France edged closer to a place in the quarterfinals.

Desire Doue equalised with a low shot from the edge of the box before Olise pulled the ball back for Rayan Cherki to put France ahead. Olise put the game to bed with a scruffy third goal before

he grabbed another in stoppage time to round off a breathtaking turnaround.

France holds a three-point lead over Italy in Group A1, with Belgium another point behind.

Italy, rebuilding under Roberto Mancini, moved up into second place courtesy of a 3-1 win over Turkiye in Bologna.

Gianluca Scamacca drilled Italy ahead only for Aral Simsir to level just after the hour. The Azzurri, who thrashed Turkiye 4-1 last week in Bursa, secured another win at home with goals from Riccardo Calafiori and Pio Esposito.

The results: League A: Group 1: France 4 (Doue 77, Cherki 81, Olise 88, 90+1) bt Belgium 1 (Lukebakio 35); Italy 3 (Scamacca 26, Calafiori 64, Esposito 87) bt Turkiye 1 (Simsir 61). **League B: Group 2:** Ukraine 1 (Varechchuk 83) lost to Hungary 2 (Toth 52, Csinger 85); Northern Ireland 0 drew with Georgia 0. **Group 4:** Romania 0 lost to Sweden 1 (Gyokeres 13); Bosnia 1 (Basic 84-pen) bt Poland 0. **League C: Group 2:** Cyprus 2 (Costi 70, Edwards 90+4) bt Latvia 1 (Daskevics 57); Montenegro 0 drew with Armenia 0.

Ganguly is DC's new head coach

IPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi Capitals announced on Tuesday that Sourav Ganguly will be the head coach of the franchise for the 2027 Indian Premier League (IPL). The 54-year-old replaces Hemang Badani at the helm of the coaching set-up.

With co-owners GMR Group and JSW Sports coming to an arrangement in 2024 that the operational control will rotate every two years, the latter will take charge of the franchise for the next two IPL seasons.

GMR was overseeing operations in 2025 and 2026, when DC finished fifth and sixth in the standings



Sourav Ganguly. FILE PHOTO

respectively.

Ganguly, who is also president of the Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB), has been JSW Sports' Director of Cricket since 2024. Earlier this year, the former India captain had taken up his first assignment as head coach at the SA20, helping Pretoria Capitals finish runner-up.

Ganguly's involvement with DC dates back to 2019 when he was roped in as an advisor. After his stint as BCCI president ended in 2022, he was back at Capitals as Director of Cricket. The upcoming season will be his first foray into the IPL as head coach.

"I am looking forward to taking on the role of head coach in the IPL. Delhi Capitals is a franchise very close to my heart, and one that I have shared a strong relationship with over the years," Ganguly stated.

"I have worked closely with the owners, management, support staff and players, which makes this an exciting responsibility for me. We have a talented group. I am looking forward to working with the squad, and building a strong and fearless team".

Prabodh knocks out Balsekar

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Suraj Prabodh rallied to stun second seed Aditya Balsekar 3-6, 6-2, 7-6 (7-4) at the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship at the DLTA Complex here on Tuesday.

Fifth seed Oges Jaya was also knocked out in the first round, losing 7-5, 2-6, 6-4 to big-serving Raghav Jaisinghani. Fourth seed Udit Kamboj, however, avoided an upset with a 6-1,

7-5 win over rising youngster Aditya Mor.

In women's singles, fifth seed Aditi Rawat, seventh seed Laxmi Siri Dandu, and eighth seed Sohini Mohanty were eliminated.

Important results (round-of-32):

Men: Suraj Prabodh bt Aditya Balsekar 2-6, 6-2, 7-6(4); Udit Kamboj bt Aditya Mor 6-1, 7-5; Deep Munim bt Prajwal Tewari 6-7(3), 6-4, 6-4; Ajay Malik bt Dhiraj Vennapusa 7-6(8), 6-7(3), 6-1.

Women: Aditi Rawat bt L.

Arunkumar 6-3, 7-5; Laxmi Siri Dandu bt A. Khorakiwala 6-2, 6-1; Sohini Mohanty bt Joell Nichole 7-5, 6-3; Bela Tamhankar bt Jasmine Rawat 6-4, 6-2.

Under-18: Boys: Praneel Sharma bt Sarthak Gaikwad 6-0, 6-3; Srivaant Mummadi bt Harsh Malik 6-0, 6-2; Om Ramesh Patel bt Mehul Jothish 6-2, 6-3; Aditya Mor bt Rishi Yadav 6-4, 6-3.

Girls: Savitha Bhuvaneshwaran bt Sarena Gahlot 6-1, 6-1.

Shreeniti Chowdhury bt Paavani Bisht 6-1, 6-0; Harsha Uruganti bt Vaishnavi Singh 6-2, 6-0; Iha Joshi bt Sree Velmankandan 6-7(4), 6-3, 6-3.

Baloda puts India in control; leggie Green claims seven

The left-arm spinner scalps four in the visitor's second innings to complete a 10-wicket match haul; the host still 55 ahead after taking a 141-run lead, thanks to Yashbardhan and Biswas' half-centuries

AUS U-19 IN INDIA

Sahil Mathur
AHMEDABAD

Tanmay Baloda continued from where he left off in the first innings, adding four more wickets to his match tally to make it a 10-for.

His spell of four for 26 put India under-19 in an advantageous position against Australia under-19 at the end of day two of the second Test at the Narendra Modi Stadium here on Tuesday.

Australia u-19 was 86 for four at stumps, trailing the host by 55 runs. India u-19 was earlier bowled out for 315 after taking a 141-run lead.

Despite India's dominance, the day still belonged to leg-spinner Spencer Green, who finished with figures of seven for 110.

Green was Australia's go-to weapon from the morning and got overnight



Justifying the faith: Green was Australia's go-to weapon and he did not disappoint. VIJAY SONEJI

batters Kushagra Ojha (29) and Yashbardhan Chauhan (52) out in consecutive ov-

ers. With only the odd ball turning, Aryan Yadav (30) and Manal Chauhan (34)

were comfortable in rotating strike while finding the fence occasionally.

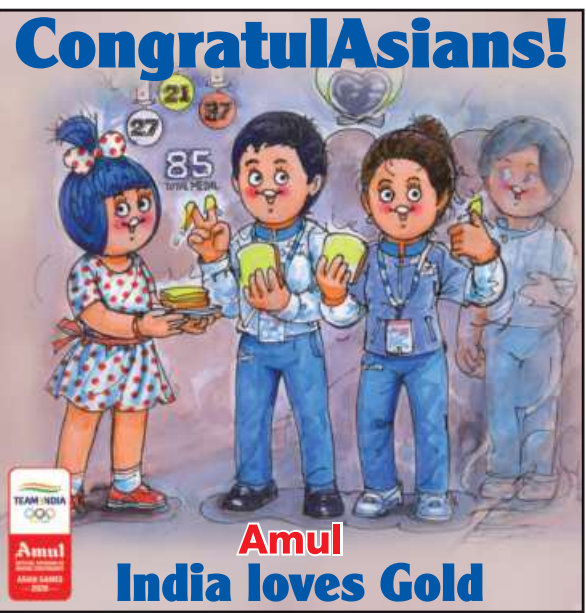
Post lunch, Yashbardhan miscued Green while Thomas Vaseo rushed Aryan to clean him up. Green then got Mohit Ulva and Ayaan Akram back-to-back.

But Abhiprai Biswas counter-attacked. He slogswept his first ball for a six and took the aerial route over the fielders whenever possible.

He brought up his fifty off just 36 balls. However, Biswas missed a straighter one to give Green his seventh scalp.

India added 42 more to its lead through the last-wicket partnership before Baloda put his side in a commanding spot with the ball, heading into the third day.

The scores: Australia u-19 174 & 86/4 in 26 overs (Tanmay Baloda 4/26) vs. India u-19 315 in 78.4 overs (Yashbardhan Chauhan 52, Abhiprai Biswas 73, Spencer Green 7/110).



Aditya Mehta hopes to deliver a special gift for his little one

CWEALTH CUE SPORTS

Tarun Shastry
CHENNAI

Aditya Mehta will have a little extra motivation when he takes the snooker table at the Commonwealth cue sports championships in Ahmedabad from Wednesday.

The former World No. 49 became a father in January, and there is one gift he would dearly love to take back home – an international title.

"I still haven't won an international tournament since my daughter's birth. That's a huge motivation. I'd like win a title for her," Aditya told *The Hindu*.

At 39, Aditya feels he has rediscovered a part of his game that had gone missing over the last few years due to injuries.

"There was a bit of a lull for me in the middle. I wasn't quite the player I used to be. I fell, and then I didn't really know where I was going. I've passed that phase now. I'm very comfortable with where I am today."

His approach to practice has changed, too.

"It is more about getting



Aditya.

quality out of those two or three hours," he said. "I try to go in every day and do something a little better."

Return to pro circuit

That renewed confidence has got Aditya thinking about a return to the professional circuit.

"A few years ago, I was not really sure whether I would ever want to go back to the professional tour. But if I continue down the road I've been on for the last year or so, I would like to have another crack at the pro tour."

For now, though, his sights are firmly set on Ahmedabad – and that special gift for his little one.

"I definitely feel the game is there, and I'd love to win this time".



File No. HO/Civil/T&E-E-5296/01/2025 28123, Dt.23/09/2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL)-III.

IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/32/26-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Swimming Pool in the district of Kandhamal, Odisha.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.1705.25 Lakhs (Approx.)

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt. 07.10.2026
ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt. 28.10.2026
iii. Opening date : 11:30 Hours of dt. 29.10.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar

4001/349/2627 **OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0127**



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, PHULBANI (R&B) CIRCLE, PHULBANI

E-mail : sernbphulbani@gmail.com

Letter No. 2063 Dated : 01/10/2026

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) - Bid Identification No.CCE_R and B_PLB_05 of 2026_27

1.	The Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE for construction of the Building works as detailed in the table below from eligible contractors.
2.	Nature of work : Building Works
3.	No. of tenders : Two Nos
4.	Tender Cost : Rs.10,000/- (through online) only.
5.	Class of Contractor : B and A Class
6.	Date & Time of sale & receipt of Bids : 10.00 AM of 07.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 21.10.2026
7.	Date of Opening of Bid : 11.00 AM of 22.10.2026
8.	The Bidders shall have to participate in online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website https://tendersodisha.gov.in . Any addendum/Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.

Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani.

34001/949/2627 **OIPR-34001/34129/1/26-27/0006**



Government Of Odisha - "e" Procurement of Notice

Bid Identification No. 12 of 2026-27

Notice No.3694 Dated.05.10.2026

Ref- TCN No.3691 Dated.05.10.2026

Sr.No.	Item	Details
1	The GENERAL MANAGER, OSAM BOARD invites percentage rate bids in Double cover system in ONLINE MODE only for work as detailed below :	
2	Nature of the work	Construction of Boundary wall at Nimapada Model Haat Nimapada
3	No of work	01 Nos
4	Bid Cost	Rs. 4000.00 online transfer.
5	Value of Tender	Rs. 1088727
6	Class of Contractor	D & C
7	Availability of BID Documents in the website	Dt. 07.10.2026 to 16.10.2026
8	Last date / time of Receipt of bids in the portal	Dt. 16.10.2026 up to 5.00 PM
9	Date of opening of bid	Dt. 21.10.2026 at 11.30 AM
10	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : https://tendersorissa.gov.in . Any Addendum/Corrigendum/Cancellation of the Tender etc. can also be seen in the website: https://tendersorissa.gov.in .	

Sd/- General Manager, O.S.A.M. Board, Bhubaneswar

39001/61/2627 **OIPR-39001/39024/1/26-27/0005**

From flying under the radar to flying high – the Savitha Shri story

The Chennai GM took the chess world by storm in her maiden Olympiad appearance, winning individual gold on the reserve board and helping India bag the team bronze

C. Shyam Sundar

Savitha Shri. Remember the name. She was the surprise package India unleashed at the 24th Olympiad in Uzbekistan recently. In a display which shocked the chess world and even herself, the 19-year-old laid down a marker for the future, with her progress set to be followed keenly. From being a kid who once sat across the table against Magnus Carlsen – who would soon go on to become the World champion in 2013 – to dazzling at the game’s ultimate team event, Savitha has come a long way. She won titles at the National level and on the world stage, bagging the under-12 crown in the World Cadets championship in 2018 and bronze in the World Rapid championship four years later.

Biggest achievements

She appeared to fly under the radar despite her talent and achievements. The Olympiad medals – individual and team – are probably her biggest prizes till date.

The Chennai WGM, who took the competition by storm with a gold medal on the reserve board, had picked up the game at the age of four watching her brother play.

However, it wasn’t a smooth ride initially. Her father Krishnan Baskar, who was working as an electrical technician in Singapore, initially thought chess wasn’t an expensive pursuit. He subsequently gave up his job abroad in an effort to back his daughter. “I got a chessboard for ₹500 and thought it was all that I needed to spend,” he said.

To his surprise, the expenses were more than what he could afford. When a little Savitha took to the game like a duck to water, the family couldn’t make ends meet and support the two children at the same time. Baskar said he had to ask his son, Mugesh, to give up chess and focus on academics. He has now completed his degree and begun working.

In the meantime, Savitha’s talent meant her father dived headlong into supporting her. He used to accompany her to tournaments and was delighted to watch her perform well.

At one point, the family began to feel the pinch financially. They had to pledge gold jewellery to make sure that her fledgling career didn’t hit a roadblock as funding her trips to play tournaments appeared to be beyond the means. “Savitha has become a mature person now,” Baskar said even as he waited patiently at the airport to welcome her after her exploits in Samarkand, where the Indian women’s team finished with a bronze.

He was delighted to see Savitha shine at the highest level and wished for more support. “*Unmaiya sollanum na, neraya support thevai* (honestly speaking, more is needed),” Baskar said, emphasising on the need for more funding to pursue chess at the top.

First-time experience

As confident as Baskar is about Savitha’s career, the teenager appears to be adapting to the new-found stardom. She didn’t seem to be weighed down by pressure despite appearing in her maiden Olympiad. “I didn’t feel it. I was part of a very supportive team... my teammates were awesome. They just told me to play my game,” she said about her undefeated run of eight victories and two draws at the global event.

She described her performance as “amazing”. “I wasn’t really expecting it. When I had four (wins) from four games, I thought I should keep pushing. As long as I score, it is better



for the team,” Savitha said while assessing her display, which was instrumental in the team clinching a spot on the podium.

She won on demand and also showed that she could defend resolutely when needed. The hard-fought draws in two matches saved the team from suffering defeats and kept it in the hunt for a medal. She, however, said: “I regret not being able to win in the final round.”

Unstoppable run

Savitha was flying in the first four rounds. But, in a surprise move, she was rested for the match against Poland, which the team went on to lose.

Asked about the decision that cost India dear, she said rather matter-of-factly: “Vantika [Agrawal] had won all three matches and was also in good form. Poland is not really that strong compared to the other teams we played. It’s unfortunate that we lost. Again, I don’t think I have to blame anyone. It was the captain’s (Swayams Mishra) decision. I completely agree with it.”

All praise for her teammates – Koneru Humpy, R. Vaishali, Diviya Deshmukh and Vantika – the Chennai player said: “What can I say? Such a supporting team. For me, it’s my first time in the Olympiad. All of them are such senior players... Humpy, Vaishali akka. They kept motivating me to play all the rounds.” But the amiable and confident



FLICKR & B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Savitha admitted that she was a bit nervous ahead of the contest against China.

“I did feel it at the start of the round. But once the game started, I wasn’t thinking about that,” she said, adding that playing five-six hours every game very tiring.

Pleasant surprise

Grandmaster Mishra couldn’t conceal his delight at the newcomer’s stunning streak. He felt that the early run gave her a lot of confidence and that she built on the fantastic start. “We expected her to do well but this one was a pleasant surprise, not just for me but for herself as well. She kept on winning, especially in many clutch games where we needed her to.”

Mishra was impressed with Savitha’s ability to recover from tough positions and win. “I think we need more players like her who are always fighting for the team.”

About her special qualities, the coach said: “Her confidence is very high... When going into the fourth hour, players get tired. That is where I think she was able to be very precise and accurate in most of her games. The moment others get tired, she has the highest energy.”

High praise from the team captain indeed!

Where it started

Savitha was trained initially by the late K. Thirukkalathy, a noted coach and former State chess association office-bearer.

“He taught me how to move the pieces. It all started from there. He was a very good coach,” she said, terming him as

“special” and the one who showed the way. She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts R. Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards.

What’s unique about her

Ramesh had good words to say about Savitha. “Over the board, she does the most practical things without much hesitation when most players would hesitate.” On her part, she said, “Ramesh sir helps by analysing games and offers psychological support. We work a lot on the middle and end-game”.

Representing India at the Olympiad was a dream for Savitha, according to her father. She made the opportunity count when it came along as she got a look-in after the experienced D. Harika opted out.

Baskar and his family were there at the airport to receive Savitha, who arrived from Uzbekistan with a couple of her compatriots (Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali). As the wait grew longer, he kept pacing around, trying to get in touch with his daughter over the phone. When she emerged, the family seemed overjoyed, with the girl’s grandmother thrilled in the moment.

Savitha is known to raise her level when the situation demands and had shown it when she bagged crucial Elo points before the covid-19 pandemic and in 2022. Now that she has gained important points with a splendid show in Samarkand, she would be motivated to get better and improve her ranking.

She is Chennai’s new superstar in chess and will look to emerge as the next big thing in the Indian sporting firmament.

THE GIST

▼ Savitha’s stunning run at the Olympiad included eight victories and two draws

▼ India women’s team captain Mishra was impressed with her ability to recover from tough positions and win

▼ She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards



In this Delhi studio, tintype brings chemistry into every portrait

Tintype is a traditional, hand-made photographic process from the mid-19th century that made portrait photography more accessible outside the formal and expensive studios of the time; it seems simple yet it conceals a process that demands scientific precision — and therein lies its charm

Aditya Ansh
NEW DELHI

In an age when a portrait can be made in a fraction of a second, Vibhav Kapoor, artist and assistant professor at O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonipat, spends several minutes making one photograph, much of the time spent negotiating with chemistry.

In his Delhi-NCR studio, Mr. Kapoor works with tintype, a 19th-century photographic process in which an image is created directly on a metal plate.

The French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin is credited with developing the technique in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process.

Chemically demanding

Unlike processes that produced glass negatives or paper prints, tintypes created a positive image directly on a dark metal plate.

Mr. Kapoor takes a plate with collodion, a syrupy solution of nitrocellulose dissolved in ether and alcohol. He pours it onto a metal plate to form a thin, sticky film, and sensitises it in a silver-nitrate bath in which the iodides and bromides react with silver nitrate to form light-sensitive silver iodide and silver bromide.

Finally, he exposes these light-sensitive compounds through a large-format camera, and develops the images in a dark room using a ferrous sulphate solution acidified with glacial acetic acid and thinned with alcohol; it amplifies the latent image by converting more exposed silver halides into visible metallic silver.

The entire sequence from coating to fixing must be completed while the plate remains wet. There is also no negative to reprint from, so duplicating tintypes is equally arduous.

19th century process

In the mid-19th century, the tintype process was valued for being relatively inexpensive and durable. The dominant photographic process of the era was the daguerreotype. It was costly because it required silver-plated copper sheets as the base material plus iodine and mercury vapour to develop images. Together with the labour-intensive crafting process, each daguerreotype was a luxury item.

Tintypes, however, afforded portraits outside the more formal, expensive photographic studios of the period. In India as well, the process formed part of the early history of photography.

In 1864, a British photographer named T. Murray introduced Sawai Ram Singh II



A tintype of Padmanabh Singh, of the erstwhile ruling dynasty of Jaipur State; (Below) portrait in tintype. VIBHAV KAPOOR/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



of Jaipur to the tintype camera and documented his court, architecture, and lives of women in the royal zenana. Murray is also known to have helped the ruler develop a royal archive of visuals.

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Jaipur royal photographer Ram Singh also used the process. “It is a very traditional, hand-made process,” Mr. Kapoor said. But its apparent simplicity conceals a process that demands scientific precision.

Mr. Kapoor first learnt tintype photography during his master’s degree at the Rochester Institute of Technology, New York, which he spent coating plates, photographing, developing, drying, and finally varnishing the finished image.

The way tintype works also affects the photographer and the subject. The CMOS sensors in today’s digital cameras are so fast that a person needs to pose for just a second. On the other hand, the light-sensitive compounds in tintype photography ‘record’ the light over 8-10 seconds, so the subjects need to present themselves still for that period.

For a portrait, as Mr. Kapoor put it,

“The person is performing ..., presenting themselves.”

The image emerges in 10 to 15 minutes thereafter.

Weather and chemistry

That said, the photograph’s most unpredictable component is the weather. “The chemistry is very volatile and humidity plays a crucial role,” Mr. Kapoor said.

“During the monsoon, the humidity causes the tintypes to develop spots,” Matthew Fossier, a U.S. tintype practitioner in Texas, said.

Dust is another serious problem. As dust particles settle on the wet collodion layer, they interrupt the formation of silver halide crystals. When the plate is developed, the affected area produces metallic silver differently from the surrounding film, and which appears as an opaque or transparent spot.

Temperature fluctuations can create other artefacts as well, per Mr. Fossier. The collodion contains volatile solvents and heat makes them evaporate faster, leaving the film to become sticky. The plate must be moved quickly to the silver-nitrate bath, where silver ions react with the halides in the collodion to form the light-sensitive silver-halide layer. If the collodion has begun to set unevenly by

then, however, the resulting layer can be uneven as well.

He added that the effect is pronounced when pouring the collodion, which reduces the time available to get the plate into the silver bath.

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Delhi-NCR temperatures require him to adjust his solutions: “Heat acts as a catalyst [and] more heat means reactions are faster. The developer has to be managed.”

The developer is a chemical solution that reveals the image captured on a sensitised metal plate after exposure. But in warmer weather, the developer works faster, causing streaks or an uneven fog to appear in the picture.

To avoid this, Mr. Kapoor dilutes the developer to change its strength and how long it stays on the plate, slowing the reaction, and allowing the picture to develop clearly.

Photography arrived in India in the 19th century, and the wet-collodion processes became ubiquitous as tintypes circulated in Indian towns in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Today, however, Mr. Kapoor said “only a handful of photographers in India practise tintype”. (Aditya Ansh is an independent media writer based in New Delhi. adityaansh30@gmail.com)

THE GIST

Tintype created images directly on metal plates; it was developed by French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process

The process was popular because it was cheap and durable unlike the more expensive daguerreotype; it made portrait photography accessible to more people outside formal studios

Tintypes became common in towns across the country during the late 19th and early 20th centuries; today, however, only a few photographers in India still practise the process

BIG SHOT



A drone view shows tourists swimming in green seawater associated with a plankton bloom, in Koh Lan, Pattaya, Chonburi province, Thailand. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Silk Road: Eurasia’s web of trade



Cultural crossroad: The main routes of the Silk Road. KELVIN CASE (CC BY-SA)

Vasudevan Mukunth

Contrary to the name, the Silk Road was a network of multiple land and maritime trade routes connecting parts of east, central, south, and west Asia. The network took different shapes over more than a millennium but became especially important from around the second century BC, when China’s Han dynasty expanded west and established contacts with Central Asian states. Because Chinese silk was a prized commodity then, the network was called the Silk Road. Since it offered well-travelled roads, the Silk Road also became the routes that technologies, religions, artistic styles, languages, and natural philosophy took to spread across Eurasia. It is in fact how papermaking spread out from China, as did how Buddhism travelled from India through Central Asia into China. Christianity, Manichaeism, and later Islam also

spread along parts of the network — just like musical traditions, and astrological and medical knowledge.

The network also benefited from the Mongol Empire bringing much of Eurasia within a connected political system in the 13th and 14th centuries, and encouraged long-distance journeys. The Road’s import gradually declined by the early modern period as trade became cheaper over sea routes, especially in the Indian Ocean, while political conditions changed on land. Even so, the network proved instrumental to make premodern Eurasia as economically and culturally interconnected as it had become, despite its size.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’